

Article | 5 August 2026

Stablecoins 101: Uncertain growth but the stakes are high

Stablecoins saw significant growth in 2025, drawing attention from issuers and regulators alike. Still, their long-term prospects remain uncertain. In the first article of our new series, we explore what stablecoins are, what could drive adoption, and why their future matters



Despite a sharp expansion, stablecoins now account for only about 7% of the broader crypto market

Executive summary

Stablecoins have seen significant growth over the past few years, reaching nearly US\$300bn in market capitalisation at the end of 2025. This rapid expansion has come with heightened attention from both regulators and potential issuers. However, the future of the crypto asset remains uncertain as further growth depends on whether it can develop beyond the crypto-landscape and expand into the broader payment world.

In our view, part of the path to becoming a broadly adopted instrument depends on the presence of a regulatory framework and interoperability with existing payment systems. However, estimating the future growth of stablecoins is difficult, as it requires predicting their relative attractiveness compared with alternative payment systems such as central bank digital currencies and tokenised deposits in a rapidly evolving

market.

While the jury is still out on how widely stablecoins could be adopted, it is important to consider a scenario in which uptake becomes significant, as this could have serious implications for financial stability, the banking sector, emerging markets, and monetary policy.

Despite the growing attention, many questions remain about what stablecoins are, how they work, and what role they could ultimately play in the financial system. In this piece, we explain the fundamentals of stablecoins, review recent market and regulatory developments, and explore the factors that could shape their future adoption. While the market is evolving quickly, their long-term prospects remain highly uncertain. Their eventual role in payments and savings will depend not only on regulation but also on whether they can compete with existing and emerging forms of digital money. In future publications, we will examine the implications of broader stablecoin adoption in more detail.

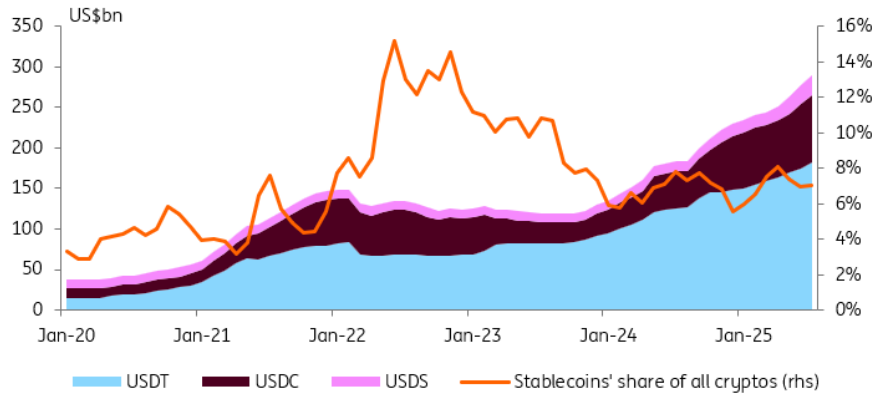
What are stablecoins?

Stablecoins are crypto assets issued by private institutions that promise a stable nominal value in a given currency, commodity or pool of assets. They are not issued or backed by a government or central authority but rather by a private institution and secured by segregated reserves. The crypto asset is issued on a Distributed Ledger Technology (DLT) (i.e. a blockchain) with three existing types of pegging mechanisms:

1. **Fiat-collateralised** stablecoins: backed 1:1 by reserves of cash or liquid assets. These are the most common and utilised type of stablecoin, currently representing over 90% of all stablecoins. We will focus on these in this piece.
2. **Crypto-collateralised** stablecoins: backed by over-collateralised crypto assets. The issuance of these stablecoins tends to be restricted by regulations such as the EU's Markets in Crypto-Assets Regulation (MiCAR).
3. **Algorithmic** stablecoins: not backed by real assets, but the peg to the chosen currency is maintained by a dynamic adjustment of the token's supply using algorithms or "smart contracts". Following the crash of the Terra project in 2022, algorithmic stablecoins now represent only a fraction of all stablecoins.

The total market capitalisation of stablecoins has surpassed US\$300bn globally, 99% of which is USD-pegged tokens. While still dwarfed by bank deposits, the rapid growth of the sector over the past five years (up by \$250bn) has drawn considerable attention. Despite the sharp expansion, though, stablecoins now account for only about 7% of the broader crypto market, a decline from their 2022 peak, as the market capitalisation of other cryptocurrencies has grown even faster.

Selected stablecoins' market capitalisation over time & share of all cryptocurrencies

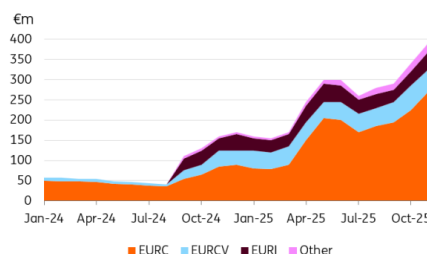


Source: ING Research, IMF / USDT = Tether, USDC = Circle, USDS = Sky Protocol

Euro-pegged stablecoins still only represent a fraction of all stablecoins in use, but their market capitalisation grew from €50m in early 2024 to nearly €400m at the end of 2025. Euro stablecoins remain in their infancy, accounting for only about 0.3% of the global stablecoin market despite recent progress.

Euro-pegged stablecoins remain at a nascent stage

Euro-pegged stablecoins' market capitalisation over time



Market capitalisation of stablecoins across currencies



Source: ING Research, ECB / EURC = Euro Circle, EURCV = Coinvertible, EURI = Eurite

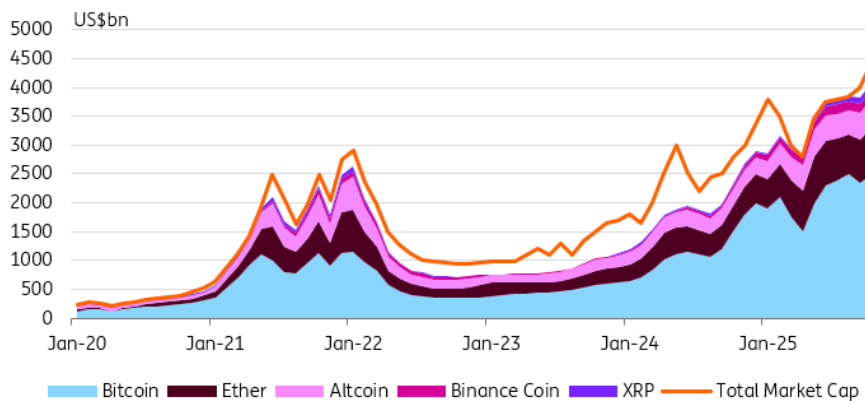
Available data shows that the use of stablecoins remains limited in the larger frame of global payments. Yet the sector's very rapid development over the past years suggests that could change. The new digital currency is forecast to grow exponentially, reaching anywhere between \$900bn and \$4.2tr by 2030. The wide variation in projections underscores just how hard it is to forecast the trajectory of stablecoins over the coming years. Indeed, **stablecoins' growth will depend on several factors: the regulation in place, interoperability with existing payment systems and, importantly, their use cases and relative attractiveness versus other payment systems (new or existing).** The next section delves into other technologies that could influence the growth (or lack thereof) of stablecoins.

How do stablecoins differ from other digital & crypto currencies?

Unbacked cryptocurrencies

Stablecoins are a form of crypto asset, but they differ from other cryptocurrencies by holding segregated reserves designed to maintain a one-to-one value with a chosen reference currency. This is not the case for “real” cryptocurrencies that are also issued and transferred using Distributed Ledger Technology (DLT) but not backed by liquid assets. These unbacked cryptocurrencies are, therefore, much more volatile and used mainly for investment and speculative purposes. Taken together, cryptocurrencies’ market capitalisation reached nearly \$4500bn at the end of 2025, about three times the level in early 2024.

Selected cryptocurrencies market capitalisation over time



Source: ING Research, IMF

Beyond stablecoins and unbacked cryptocurrencies, a new wave of digital currencies is gaining traction among both prospective issuers and regulators.

Tokenised assets

Tokenised assets are digital representations of real-world assets on a distributed ledger infrastructure. A wide range of underlying assets can be tokenised, including securities, bank deposits, and real estate.

Tokenisation is increasingly being explored for bank deposits, where the deposit itself is represented, stored, and issued on a DLT. Each token corresponds to a direct claim on a regulated commercial bank and remains on that bank’s balance sheet. Unlike stablecoins, tokenised deposits do not circulate as bearer instruments but are tied to identified account holders.

The usage of tokenised deposits currently remains limited and mostly experimental. However,

tokenised deposits can modernise payment and settlement infrastructures, as well as intragroup liquidity management. They promise faster settlement (near-instant, in fact), 24/7 transactions, programmability, and lower operational frictions (reducing reliance on multiple intermediaries). Tokenised deposits also offer regulatory advantages, as they remain fully within the existing supervisory framework; the underlying assets stay on commercial banks' balance sheets, preserving the same oversight and prudential standards applied to traditional deposits.

Central Bank Digital Currencies

Central Bank Digital Currencies (CBDCs) are digital forms of money that allow users to pay each other using a direct claim on the central bank. In other words, it aims to reinvent central bank money (cash and coins) in a digital form. CBDCs are often compared and opposed to stablecoins, but the main difference is their direct claim to the central bank. They are issued and maintained by the central authority, often but not systematically using DLTs.

CBDCs can be built for retail or wholesale use (for interbank settlements and large-value transfers). Only a few CBDCs are currently in use in the world (Bahamas, Jamaica, Nigeria and China with a large-scale pilot). But over 100 countries have projects to develop their own digital currency. This includes the EU, which is currently developing its own retail CBDC (the digital euro) and aiming for a 2029 launch. Read more on this in our piece [*The digital euro is making progress, European banks should pay attention*](#).

In addition to the digital euro, the EU is looking at developing a wholesale DLT settlement strategy. The near-term project 'Pontes' will leverage existing T2 infrastructure and provide immediate central bank money settlement. It's expected to be launched in 3Q 2026. The European Central Bank also plans a full DLT-based wholesale CBDC ecosystem under the 'Appia' initiative, with a blueprint expected in 2028.

To summarise the four digital currencies discussed, the table below highlights the key differences across their main attributes.

Currencies comparison table

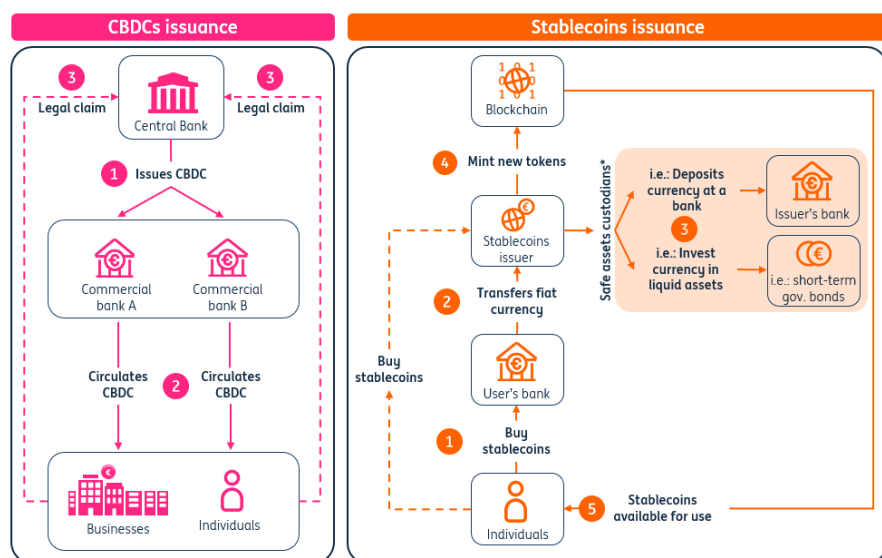
	Stablecoins	CBDCs	'Real' cryptos	Tokenised deposits	Bank deposits	Cash
Digital	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗
Public	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓
Blockchain use	✓	~	✓	✓	✗	✗
Programmable	✓	~	✓	✓	~	✗
Use without intermediaries	✓	~	✓	✗	✗	✓
Large price volatility	Limited by pegging mechanism	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗
Means of payment role	✓	✓	Not in the wider economy	✓	✓	✓
Unit of account role (used for invoicing)	✓	✓	Not in the wider economy	✓	✓	✓
Store of value role	Potential, especially if remuneration allowed	Not if implementation of holding limits	✗	Linked to real-world bank deposits	✓	✓
Regulation	Fragmented	National	Fragmented	✓	✓	✓

~ Possible ✗ No ✓ Yes

Source: ING Research

Both stablecoins and CBDCs aim to create a more digital and efficient means of payment, yet they are often portrayed as competing alternatives. Despite this, the two forms of digital money differ significantly. Their key differences can be illustrated through their issuance models, shown in the flowchart below.

CBDCs versus stablecoins issuance flow



Source: ING Research *examples of safe asset custodians, can vary depending on the regulation in place

The approach to stablecoins and CBDCs varies across the globe, with notable differences between the US and Europe. The transatlantic divide became increasingly apparent in the summer of 2025, when the US moved to support dollar-backed stablecoins while prohibiting the issuance of a CBDC. Europe has taken a different approach, arguing that a CBDC, the digital

euro, would enhance regulatory oversight through issuance and supervision by the European Central Bank.

Given the starkly different political approaches across jurisdictions, stablecoins are likely to evolve as primarily domestic or regional instruments, a dynamic that could shape and, potentially, constrain their overall growth potential.

For stablecoins to become systemically important, their use needs to extend beyond the crypto ecosystem into the broader, global, payments world. However, political positions are already signalling resistance to a global (dollar-pegged) stablecoin, with policymakers instead encouraging the development of multiple domestic stablecoins denominated in local currencies.

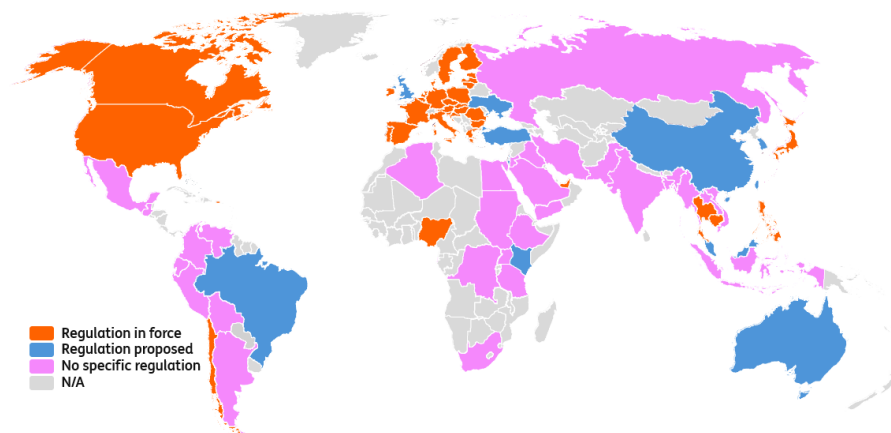
The absence of regulatory harmonisation reinforces this trend. Stablecoin issuers must adapt to each jurisdiction's rules, limiting cross-border scalability and undermining the emergence of a single dominant global stablecoin. The next section outlines the regulatory divergences across the US, EU, and UK.

Large regulatory differences and crucial remuneration uncertainty

Currently, 12 countries have stablecoin regulations in force, and another 10 have proposed texts that are not yet approved. The strongest stance against the issuance of stablecoins comes from China, where they're banned. This partly stems from the government's push for its CBDC; stablecoins are therefore viewed as direct competition.

The main laws are in place in the trading hubs, while other markets still lack specific stablecoin and crypto asset regulations. Despite recent developments at the national or regional level, there's an absence of international harmonisation and coordination on the topic.

Distribution of current stablecoin regulations worldwide



Source: ING Research, Visual capitalist

Because of the lack of international harmonisation on stablecoin oversight, existing regulatory frameworks diverge in several ways. The most important difference concerns the management of the safe assets. Indeed, issuers face various types and levels of restrictions for the segregated reserves. This could influence stablecoins' potential impact on the financial system.

Under US regulation (GENIUS Act), issuers must hold at least \$1 of permitted reserves for every \$1 of stablecoins issued. Permitted reserves include (but are not exclusively) cash, deposits held at commercial banks, short-dated treasury bills and other similar government-issued assets approved by regulators. The absence of specific limits or thresholds on each of these options gives USD-stablecoin issuers a relatively large degree of freedom to allocate their reserves.

This isn't replicated in the European legislation. MiCAR sets stricter requirements for E-Money institute issuers. These institutions (if systemic) are required to hold at least 60% of the safe assets as commercial banks' deposits (30% if non-systemic issuers). They're allowed to hold 40% of their reserves in liquid government bonds (70% if non-systemic issuers).

While the UK is still drafting its final stablecoin regulatory framework, the latest proposal includes restrictions on reserve investments. For systemic issuers, the Bank of England proposes prohibiting the use of commercial bank deposits and requiring that at least 30% of backing assets be held as non-remunerated central bank deposits. The remaining 70% could be invested in short-term government debt. The central bank argues that allowing commercial bank deposits as backing could introduce financial, operational, and contagion risks that could amplify a stress across the sector. Additionally, the UK is the first country to propose a temporary issuance guardrail for systemic issuers, limiting the amount of stablecoins issued to £40bn per issuer for an unspecified temporary period.

While myriad other divergences exist, we also note one convergence between the US, EU and UK regulatory frameworks: the ban on remuneration distribution. All three regimes prohibit stablecoin issuers from paying interest to holders. In the US, where broader crypto market legislation is still under negotiation, this restriction is heavily debated and could ultimately be revised.

Interest payments by stablecoin issuers remain prohibited in most jurisdictions. This restriction is central to the regulatory architecture, as it directly shapes stablecoins' appeal as a store of value and influences both adoption dynamics and its potential footprint in the broader financial system.

The table below summarises the main differences between the three regulatory frameworks. Read more on the various regulatory frameworks in the footnotes.

Summary of the US, EU and UK stablecoins regulatory frameworks

		US ¹ Genius Act	EU MiCAR		UK ² Regulation	
			E-money institute	Credit institution	Non-systemic issuers	Systemic issuers
1.	Access to central bank, lender of last resort	Case-by-case Fed decision	Forbidden	No restrictions		Bank of England considering backstop facility
	Central Bank deposit	Case-by-case Fed decision	Forbidden	Allowed	Allowed	Required i) ≥30% of assets; ii) upremunerated
2.	Asset investment policy					
	Commercial bank deposit	Allowed upper limit to be specified	Required ≥60% of assets (≥30% if non-systemic)	Allowed	Allowed	Forbidden
	Government bonds	Allowed ≤3m maturity	Allowed <40% of assets (<70% if non-systemic)	Allowed	Allowed	Allowed <70% of assets
3.	Stablecoins remuneration	Forbidden for issuer only	Forbidden for issuer and crypto-asset service providers (CASP)	Forbidden for issuer and CASP	Forbidden for issuer	Forbidden for issuer
4.	Issuance guardrail	None	None	None	N/A	Temporary £40bn

Source: ING Research, Fed, European Commission, BoE

1 US has three license levels: for a) bank and b) non-banks at federal level, and c) one at state level for smaller institutions. 2 Proposed UK-regime based on June 2026 proposal in Bank of England consultation

...driving the key uncertainty on stablecoins' uptake

Stablecoins' rapid growth over the past few years, in association with the lack of regulation, has raised concern for central banks across the world. Depending on future growth and use cases, stablecoins could have a significant impact on financial stability. For this to materialise, stablecoin use and adoption would have to go beyond the niche crypto-ecosystem and extend to the payment landscape.

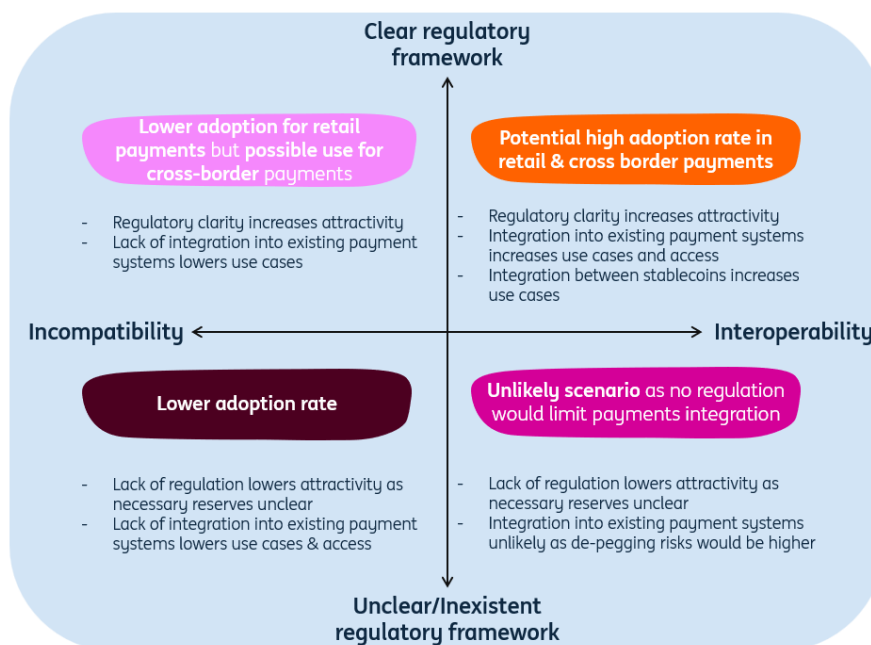
While stablecoins have grown significantly over the years, they are not currently "broadly

adopted". Currently, there's no set threshold determining what would constitute this broad adoption. Furthermore, the development of the crypto asset over the next few years remains unclear. In our view, the adoption uptake would depend on its use for two things:

- Payments
- As a store of value

Starting with the use of stablecoins in payments, there are three main variables. The first two factors are the presence of a regulatory framework and the degree of interoperability between stablecoins and existing payment systems. Mapping these variables produces a quadrant that illustrates four potential development paths for stablecoins.

Potential development of stablecoins in retail payments



Source: ING Research

A scenario with both a clear regulatory framework and full integration of stablecoins into existing payment systems would provide fertile ground for meaningful adoption in payments. However, the extent of such uptake depends on the third variable: the attractiveness of other payment systems (new and existing ones).

The existence and development of alternatives such as tokenised deposits and central bank digital currencies might limit the relative attractiveness of stablecoins. Even though payment systems in Europe remain relatively cheap and fast, that experience is far from universal internationally. For regions where payments are costly and slow, introducing new technologies such as tokenisation into existing systems could allow them to rapidly close the gap with the

advantages stablecoins offer, and potentially emerge as direct competitors to the crypto asset.

There is also a potential political push toward adopting central bank digital currencies, a dynamic relevant not only for jurisdictions with high payment costs but for the EU as well. The digital euro has become a central topic in the 'strategic payment autonomy' discussion and could directly compete with stablecoins for day-to-day payment use.

When it comes to the use of stablecoins as a store of value, a significant uptake would depend on two points:

- Whether direct remuneration by stablecoin issuers is allowed. The current ban on direct remuneration in major jurisdictions does little to support the use of stablecoins as deposit-like instruments, except in countries where real interest rates are negative. However, we can't exclude regulatory changes in coming years, especially as the topic is currently under discussion in the US with the upcoming Clarity Act. Read more on this in our regulatory footnotes below.
- The interest rate level paid on alternative deposit accounts (such as traditional bank deposits), as stablecoins could become more of a competitor to traditional deposit accounts in an environment where interest rates are zero or close to zero (which has been the case in the EU in recent years and is still the case in the US).

Only if, and with the right combination of these factors, could we foresee the adoption of stablecoins growing significantly to become broadly adopted. Yet, at present, it remains difficult to estimate the direction the crypto asset will follow in the years ahead.

Potential implications of stablecoins

Although stablecoins are not yet widely adopted and their future trajectory remains hard to pin down, our forthcoming articles will explore a scenario in which they scale enough to become a meaningful payment system. We see this as a necessary exercise: broad stablecoin adoption could carry significant and far-reaching implications for the financial system – spanning the banking sector, emerging market stability, safe asset demand, monetary policy transmission, and even geopolitical and cyber-risk dynamics.

Indeed, research has found that upon broad adoption, stablecoins could drive significant changes in banks' funding. Depending on the required reserves, this could translate into either a net drop in retail deposits or a switch from retail into wholesale deposits (as MiCAR requires stablecoin issuers to hold part of the reserves in EU commercial banks). Overall, it could make banks' funding structure more volatile as wholesale deposits are known to be less steady funding sources than retail ones (which are rarely moved across institutions). Also, wholesale deposits are costlier to hold for banks as the regulation imposes higher capital requirements, reflecting their higher volatility and general risk level.

Stablecoins could also have implications in emerging markets through currency substitution. It could amplify depreciation pressures under stress episodes by lowering friction around moving local currency into USD stablecoins. Countries with weak monetary credibility (i.e. high inflation, low interest rates) make stablecoins an attractive store of value and payment means, even outside stress episodes. The outflow to stablecoins could further undermine monetary policy transmission.

USD stablecoins also have the potential to boost demand for short-term US treasuries as issuers look for safe asset reserves. In principle, quick changes in transaction-driven demand could then amplify volatility in rates under a stress scenario. The proliferation of stablecoins (regardless of the currency) may also shift the composition of the overall monetary base with an asset reallocation from bank deposits into treasury/government bonds. This means potentially weaker monetary policy transmission through both the credit and interest rate channels.

While all these points remain theoretical implications of stablecoins, regulators are increasingly concerned and estimates on those impacts are developing. In future reports, we aim to contribute to the growing body of literature on this subject by diving deeper into each of these potential implications, seriously considering a scenario where stablecoins become a broadly adopted payment system.

Stablecoins are growing but the jury is still out on how big they'll get

Over the last few years, the market capitalisation of stablecoins has grown significantly, attracting the attention of both potential issuers and regulators across the globe. However, when it comes to the development of the crypto asset, it remains difficult to estimate an exact path. In our view, the growth of stablecoins in the coming years could be limited or strong depending on their uptake in both payments and as a store of value. Part of this growth to become a “broadly adopted” instrument depends on the existence of a regulatory framework and the interoperability with existing payment systems. The difficulty in estimating stablecoin growth comes from predicting the relative attractiveness versus alternative payment systems (new or old) as the sector quickly evolves.

It's important to consider a scenario where the use of stablecoins increases significantly, as this could have serious implications for financial stability, the banking sector, and emerging markets, as well as monetary policy. Therefore, in our upcoming series of articles, we will dive into potential impacts in more depth, starting with the implications of “broadly adopted” stablecoins for financial institutions.

Regulatory footnotes

The United States' GENIUS Act

Adopted in July 2025, the Guiding and Establishing National Innovation for US Stablecoins Act (GENIUS Act) establishes a regime to regulate US payment stablecoins. Despite the enforcement starting in January 2027, the mere adoption of the GENIUS Act had an immediate effect on USD-denominated stablecoins, with net stablecoin creation growing from about \$10bn in 2Q25 (before the regulation) to over \$45bn in 3Q25, a 324% increase in just a couple of months.

The regulation permits stablecoins to be issued by banks, credit unions and certain non-bank entities (although non-bank issuers are limited to financial firms unless the Stablecoin Certification Review Committee (SCRC) unanimously determines that they do not pose a risk to the banking or financial system).

Issuers face tailored capital, liquidity, and risk management rules but are not subject to the regulatory capital standards for “traditional” banks. Banks issuing stablecoins are regulated by the Federal Reserve, while non-banks fall under the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency (OCC) oversight.

Aside from permitted issuers, the GENIUS Act also clarifies stablecoin requirements. **Issuers must hold at least \$1 of permitted reserves for every \$1 of stablecoins issued.**

Permitted reserves include (but are not limited to) USD cash, deposits held at commercial banks, short-dated treasury bills and other similar government-issued assets approved by regulators.

Additionally, issuers of the digital currency must comply with several transparency and reporting requirements, including regular reporting on the reserve composition, and must run audits by public accounting firms. They are required to disclose the redemption procedures and comply with the US Bank Secrecy Act as well as tailored Anti-Money Laundering and Counter-Terrorism Financing (AML/CTF) rules.

The GENIUS Act also currently prohibits issuers from paying interest to stablecoin holders. However, the topic is open to discussion in the US as the proposed CLARITY Act (which aims to clarify the broader crypto asset regulatory landscape) could include the possibility for stablecoin issuers to distribute customer rewards.

The EU's Markets in Crypto-Assets Regulation (MiCAR)

MiCAR was adopted in 2023 and covers a wide range of crypto assets. The stablecoin rules gradually came into force through the end of 2024. They apply to both issuers and entities offering trading, custody, exchange and advisory on crypto assets. **MiCAR classifies crypto assets in three categories:**

- **Asset-Referenced Tokens (ARTs)**: stablecoins backed by a basket of assets such as fiat currencies or commodities
- **E-Money Tokens (EMTs)**: stablecoins pegged to a single fiat currency
- **Other crypto assets**: including decentralised cryptocurrencies and other tokens (not falling into the first two categories)

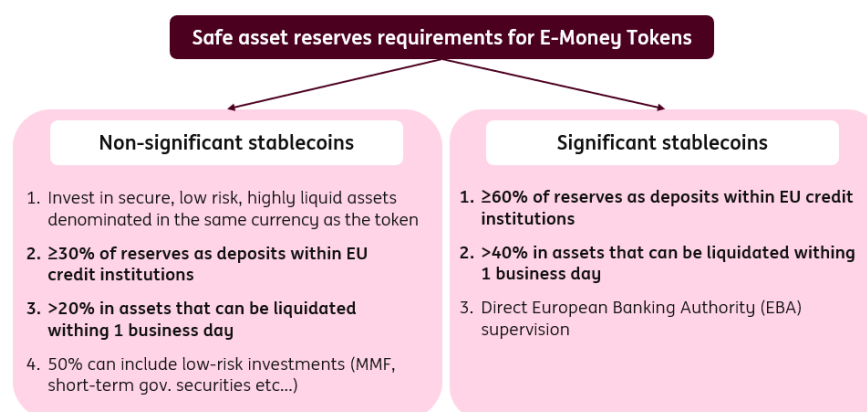
The regulation clarifies which entities are allowed to issue crypto assets in the Union, namely credit institutions and Authorised Electronic Money Institutions (EMIs). In addition, the EU differentiates cryptocurrencies by their size, including specific requirements for the largest assets.

Stablecoins are considered significant when (but not only):

- The **number of holders** is larger than **10m**
- The **value of the token** issued (market capitalisation or size of the reserve of assets) is higher than **€5bn**
- The **average number and transaction value per day** are higher than **2.5m and €0.5bn**, respectively

Under MiCAR, stablecoin issuers are required to have a legal entity established in the EU. The regulation sets out a list of requirements for stablecoins issued in the EU, starting with the prohibition on the distribution of interest on the tokens. It also establishes requirements for stablecoin reserves. For E-Money Tokens (EMTs) specifically, regulatory requirements differ depending on whether the issuer is classified as significant or not. The graph below summarises the safe assets requirements depending on the size of the stablecoin issuer.

MiCAR safe asset requirements per stablecoin issuer type



Source: ING Research, MiCA Regulation

Additionally, all issuers of stablecoins in the EU are subject to transparency and reporting requirements, including the publication of whitepapers on the token's functionality, risk and technology. Issuers must run quarterly stress testing and comply with the Union's AML/CTF

rules.

The UK's upcoming regulation

In June 2026, the Bank of England published a policy statement and draft rules for systemic stablecoin issuers. The BoE's approach to stablecoin regulation varies from existing frameworks as it plans to ban systemic issuers from holding part of their reserves with commercial banks.

The central bank argues that this decision is warranted by the financial, operational, and contagion risks that could arise between stablecoins and the broader financial system during periods of stress. This stance contrasts with the EU stablecoin regulation that requires issuers to hold part of their reserves as commercial bank deposits.

Issuers would therefore be required to hold at least 30% of the reserves in unremunerated BoE deposits and the remaining 70% in short-term UK government debt securities with a residual maturity of up to six months.

The draft rule sets aside the individual holding limit requirement announced previously and instead proposes a temporary issuance guardrail to mitigate risks to credit provision. Each systemic stablecoin issuer will be subject to an initial maximum issuance of £40bn. This limit would be reviewed, loosened and ultimately removed; the BoE doesn't include a timeline for such phasing out. If enforced as such, the UK would be the first country to officially regulate the amount of stablecoins issued, even on a temporary basis.

The proposal plans to require systemic stablecoin issuers to conduct an overall risk assessment to identify, monitor and mitigate risks. Additionally, it sets minimum capital requirements composed of six months of the issuer's relevant operating expenses or the cost of executing its recovery plan. It also requires notifying the central bank when its capital falls below 110% of the minimum requirements.

The Bank of England plans to install a statutory trust mechanism comprising two trusts: one to protect coinholders' interests and the other to cover the costs of returning value to them. Stablecoin issuers will thus be required to segregate the assets used for reserves and appoint third-party custodians to hold these. The proposal also includes a prohibition on the payment of interest and income to coinholders.

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GERMANY

Low water levels are new setback for the German economy

Record low water levels in the Rhine could shave 0.3 percentage points off Germany's GDP growth this year



A heatwave in Germany has pushed Rhine water levels to record lows

Some might know that I used to be, and still am, a passionate rower. Rowing on Frankfurt's Main River is not always a pleasure. High water levels and strong currents in winter, combined with commercial river traffic throughout the year, do not make it an ideal place to train. That is, except when water levels are low.

For rowers, low water levels mean calm currents, flat water and very little traffic. Against this backdrop, I have witnessed the effects of climate change during the 12 years I have lived in Frankfurt: fewer periods of high water in winter and longer stretches of flat water in summer. Unfortunately, what has been good for my favourite hobby has become a clear risk for the German economy: low water levels.

Why the Rhine matters for German industry

Yesterday, my colleague Rico Luman [wrote about the impact of low water levels](#) in the Rhine and the consequences for supply chains. For Germany, however, the Rhine is not simply one transport option among many. It is a piece of industrial infrastructure around which much of German industry was physically built.

Roughly 285 million tonnes of freight move along the river annually, making it Europe's most

important logistics corridor after the open seas. It carries about 80% of all goods transported on Germany's inland waterways, while some 600 vessels cross the Dutch-German border every day. The corridor connects Rotterdam directly to three of Germany's largest industrial clusters: Rhine-Ruhr steel, Rhine-Main and the Ludwigshafen chemical complex.

This is no coincidence. The plants were built along the Rhine in the nineteenth century to benefit from barge transport and access to process water, and they have remained there ever since. When the Rhine runs low, the impact extends far beyond supply chains; it strikes at the heart of German industry.

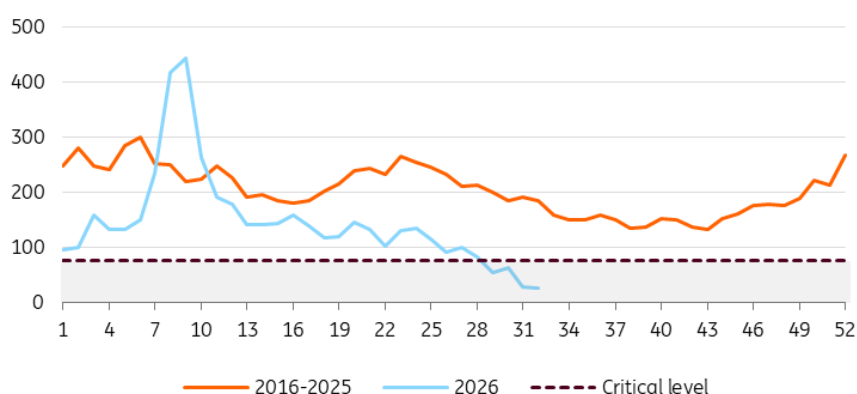
The Rhine's historic importance also means there are no real alternatives. Replacing a single barge can require up to 100 trucks or an entire freight train. And that's before taking into account Germany's well-known infrastructure challenges. Rail and road simply cannot provide a like-for-like substitute for Rhine transport. This is not to say that industry has not reacted to more frequent and longer periods of low water levels. Think of shallow-water barges and higher inventory levels.

Economic impact of low water levels

On Monday, the water level at Kaub fell to 24cm, the lowest level since records began in 1880. The last record low was 25cm in October 2018. This highlights how severe the current situation is. Normally, periods of low water occur between September and November, not in the middle of summer. Yet current forecasts for the next two weeks show little rainfall, suggesting that conditions are likely to worsen.

Water level in Kaub

(average per calendar week in cm)



Source: pegelonline.wsv.de

As the Rhine is home to crucial industries, the economic impact of supply chain constraints, and a potential reduction in production is much larger than the Rhine's c.6% share of total

German freight volume would suggest.

A 2020 Kiel Working Paper found that low water levels in the Rhine, particularly during the 2018 drought, affected the German economy through both transport and production channels. A full month of low water reduced inland shipping volumes by about a quarter, while industrial production fell by roughly 1%. Overall, the 2018 episode is estimated to have shaved around 0.3 percentage points off German GDP growth.

The risk is high that this time around, the economic impact will be larger. The low water levels at the start of August are unprecedented and fully out-of-sample when taking the Kiel paper as a proxy. Obviously, the economic impact now highly depends on the length of the current drought. A week of heavy rain could change the economic picture for the better immediately – even if this currently appears unlikely to happen. Unless the German government finds a reliable rainmaker, we should prepare to see a repetition of 2018 with a negative impact of at least 0.3 percentage points of GDP growth. This comes as a big setback given that the German economy has grown for three quarters in a row and was on track to reach annual GDP growth of some 0.8% this year. A blow to the recovery but not enough to ignite recession fears.

In any case, the negative economic impact will probably make my next outing less enjoyable. Or perhaps not. I may simply find myself humming R.E.M.'s *It's the End of the World as We Know It (And I Feel Fine)*.

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Article | 4 August 2026

TMT

Webinar: The AI race – who will fund and fuel the next wave?

AI is becoming one of the biggest investment, infrastructure and energy stories of our time. Join us to explore how the AI boom is being financed, what investors are watching, and whether power systems can keep pace with soaring demand. [Sign up here](#)



AI is no longer just a technology story. As investment and power needs surge, it has become a capital markets, infrastructure and energy story, too. The race to build AI capabilities is driving unprecedented spending on data centres, compute capacity and power infrastructure. This raises important questions for investors, policymakers and industry leaders.

In this webinar, we will explore how AI expansion is being financed, how investors are assessing the opportunity, and how energy systems can keep pace with growing demand.

You'll learn:

- Why accelerating data centre investment can remain sustainable
- What investors are watching across the largest technology companies
- How AI is reshaping capital markets and financing needs
- How data centres are transforming energy systems and local economies
- How power infrastructure can keep pace — and at what cost

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Details

Date: Thursday 13 August

Time: 1400 BST/1500 CEST/0900 ET

The webinar will last 30 minutes, including Q&A.

The event will take place online and the waiting room will open 60 minutes ahead of the scheduled start time.

A joining link will be emailed following registration, and you will receive a reminder email 10 minutes before the scheduled start time.

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Article | 4 August 2026

ROMANIA

The Danube runs dry: Romania's latest macro stress test

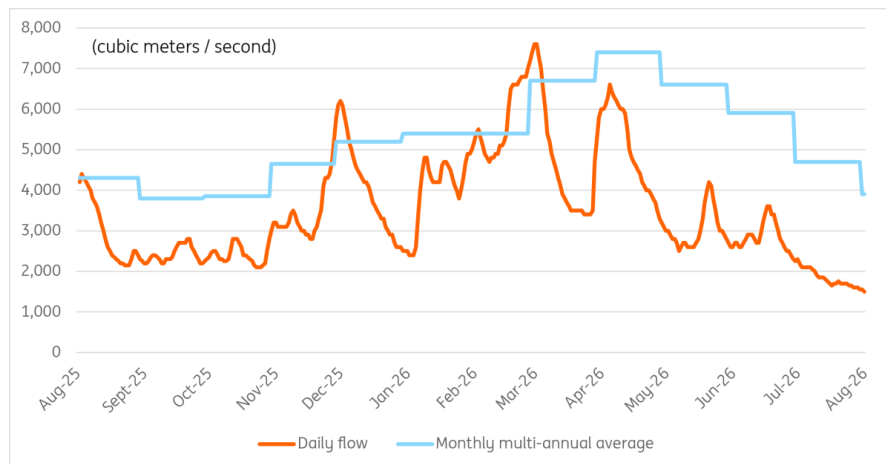
Record-low water levels on the [Rhine](#) show that climate risks are no longer exceptional shocks to otherwise predictable supply chains. As [Germany's](#) experience shows, major waterways are more than just transport routes; they are enablers of industrial activity. On the Danube, Romania faces a test of its power system, industry and trade infrastructure



The Danube in Romania, with extensive exposed sandbanks

At Baziaş, where the Danube enters Romania, river flow fell to 1600 cubic metres per second on 31 July, compared with a normal July average of 4700 cubic metres. It has since dropped further to 1500 cubic metres. Shipping has been partially disrupted, irrigation restricted and several ferry services suspended. The authorities have also had to manage reservoir levels to preserve cooling water for the Cernavodă nuclear power station.

Danube water flows: mind the gap



Source: National Institute of Hydrology, ING

In isolation, low river levels would probably be a manageable sectoral shock. What gives the current episode macroeconomic significance is its timing. Romania entered the second half of 2026 with the economy stagnant at best, industrial production in prolonged decline and inflation still high. We expect GDP to contract by 0.5% this year, after growth of only 0.7% in 2025. With such weak numbers, there is almost no cyclical cushion to absorb another supply shock.

An energy emergency with a long history

The most immediate pressure has come through electricity. Cernavodă normally supplies roughly one-fifth of Romania's power. As Danube levels fell below the thresholds needed for cooling operations, one of the plant's two reactors was disconnected from the grid. The government subsequently declared a nationwide state of emergency for August and allocated funding for temporary works to redirect water towards the remaining operating reactor. On 3 August, the Romanian military used controlled explosions to remove a rock formation obstructing the necessary works.

That is an extraordinary response, but it should not be mistaken for an energy strategy. Blasting rock out of a riverbed may keep a reactor operating for a few more days, but it does not create new generation capacity, reinforce cross-border interconnections or accelerate storage deployment. The government has acknowledged that limited interconnection capacity with Central and Western Europe reduces Romania's ability to cover the shortfall through imports.

The drought exposes a more uncomfortable truth. Romania's current emergency measures are addressing not only an extreme summer, but also decades in which essential energy investments were delayed, redesigned or left at the planning stage. The country has a

comparatively balanced generation mix, combining hydro, nuclear, fossil fuels, wind and solar. Yet diversity of technologies does not always mean diversity of risks. Nuclear cooling, hydroelectric production, river transport and parts of agriculture all depend on the same increasingly unreliable water system.

Meanwhile, the energy transition has progressed unevenly. Solar capacity, including that of prosumers, has increased rapidly, but flexible generation, storage and stronger interconnections have not expanded at the same pace. Plans for new nuclear units, reactor refurbishment, gas generation and grid upgrades have existed for years. The present crisis is therefore part climate shock and part implementation deficit. Today's improvised engineering works are, in effect, compensating for yesterday's missed investment decisions.

For the macro outlook, the key transmission channel is not necessarily a prolonged physical shortage of electricity. It is the price and confidence effect. When stable nuclear supply falls just as heat pushes demand higher, Romania must rely more heavily on imports and higher-cost domestic generation. That adds pressure to margins and threatens another round of electricity cost pass-through. It comes at a time when inflation has remained around 10.0% for the last four quarters, and energy-price liberalisation is already part of the inflation story. Our current forecast sees inflation ending 2026 at around 6.0%, but a persistent power shock would make that path less certain.

Industry did not need another shock

The energy squeeze is hitting an already weak industrial sector as well. Industrial production fell by 3.1% year-on-year in January–May 2026, while manufacturing declined by 4.3%. This is more than a temporary cyclical downturn. Romanian industry has struggled since before the pandemic, reflecting weak Western European demand, financing and energy costs, ageing capital stock and persistent competitiveness constraints.

The decision by Dacia and Ford automakers to pause production until 19 August reduces electricity demand by around 200MW, according to the prime minister. The distinction between emergency curtailment and normal scheduling is important: Ford said that its summer holiday stoppage had been planned in advance. Nevertheless, the fact that the authorities are relying on large manufacturers to help balance the system illustrates the limited short-term alternatives available.

The direct GDP hit from several weeks of lower automotive output should not be overstated. Some lost production may be recovered later, and the summer period is normally affected by maintenance and holidays. But the broader signal is that energy-intensive manufacturers are being asked to act as the power system's informal shock absorber at a time when industrial margins and investment appetite are already under pressure.

This reinforces a split currently visible in Romania's economy. Manufacturing is contracting,

while construction is growing strongly on the back of infrastructure works and EU-funded investment. Construction output rose by 11.3% year-on-year in the first five months of 2026, helping to prevent a deeper downturn. That support is valuable, but it cannot indefinitely substitute for a competitive tradable sector. Romania needs roads, railways and energy infrastructure to lift industrial potential, not merely to keep headline GDP afloat.

The Danube loses some of its cost advantage

Low water reduces the navigable depth of the Danube, forcing vessels to carry lighter loads, wait for improved conditions or transfer cargo to road and rail. On parts of the Bulgarian-Romanian stretch, cargo vessels have reportedly been operating at around half capacity because of draft restrictions, while low-water surcharges have been introduced. In Romania, idle grain barges and suspended ferry services have already been reported.

This matters because the Danube is more than a national waterway. Together with Constanța and the Danube-Black Sea Canal, it forms part of a strategic corridor connecting Central Europe, the Black Sea, Ukraine and Moldova. The corridor has become more important since the war in Ukraine started, particularly for agricultural exports and regional supply-chain resilience. When barge capacity falls, the consequences include higher transport costs, congestion on alternative routes and reduced reliability precisely when companies are being encouraged to diversify logistics networks.

Romania still has a strong strategic position. Schengen membership, motorway development, the port of Constanța and the final push to complete EU-funded transport projects could strengthen the country's role as a regional logistics and production platform. But low Danube levels provide a useful warning: building individual assets is not enough. Romania also needs redundancy between river, rail and road, reliable access to Black Sea capacity and infrastructure designed for a climate in which low-water episodes are likely to be more disruptive. The wider Danube basin authorities already identify longer and more frequent summer droughts, together with water scarcity affecting agriculture, energy and navigation, as a structural adaptation challenge.

The macro effect: stagflationary, but manageable

The drought alone is unlikely to change Romania's annual GDP trajectory dramatically. Its effects may also be partially reversible if river levels recover and industrial production is rescheduled. But it is nevertheless a stagflationary shock: it reduces output while raising electricity, transport and potentially food-production costs.

The economy is especially sensitive because domestic demand has already weakened sharply. GDP fell by 1.2% year-on-year in the first quarter with household consumption declining by 1.8%. Employment has also fallen from its early-2025 peak. Under normal circumstances, weaker demand would help bring inflation down, but the Danube shock complicates that

adjustment by adding supply-side price pressures.

One positive feature of the current macro mix is that EU-financed investment is providing a buffer. Investment rose by 2.2% year-on-year in the first quarter, while EU-funded public investment increased strongly during the first half. Romania is also approaching the final stage of its Recovery and Resilience Facility programme, with the fifth and sixth payment requests expected in August and September. If execution remains on track, 2026 could bring historically high EU inflows.

That makes the composition of investment more important than ever. The last-mile RRF push should not be judged only by how much money is absorbed before the deadline. Its success should also be measured by whether projects reduce the economic cost of the next drought. Energy networks, storage, interconnections, irrigation, rail links, port access and navigability are not separate policy files. They are components of the same resilience strategy.

A warning that should survive the summer

The Danube drought will not derail Romania's economy, but an economy already in stagnation has very little room for avoidable shocks. Each individual disruption may look small: a reactor offline, a temporary factory stoppage, a lighter barge or a suspended ferry. Together, they expose the same structural weakness. Romania has spent years relying on favourable geography and a diversified energy mix without investing enough in the systems that make those advantages resilient.

The emergency response can preserve supply this summer but it cannot substitute for a serious long-term energy and transport strategy. The policy test begins after the water returns: whether Romania treats the episode as an exceptional natural event, or as a warning that climate adaptation, energy security and industrial competitiveness have become the same macroeconomic issue.

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Article | 3 August 2026

FX

Washington joins the fight for the yen

US and Japanese authorities have confirmed that they have jointly intervened in FX markets to support the yen. Joint intervention is rare and points to new FX activism from the US Treasury. Yet a successful turn lower in USD/JPY will require softer US data, no Fed hikes and possibly some new initiatives from Japan to keep more money at home



The US dollar has weakened sharply against the Japanese yen after market intervention

Q: What's happened?

Reports over the weekend suggest US and Japanese authorities have jointly intervened to support the yen. This marks the first coordinated G7 FX intervention since March 2011 following Japan's earthquake and tsunami, and the first joint US-Japan yen-buying intervention since June 1998, when USD/JPY was approaching 150 during the Asian financial crisis.

Tokyo appears to have remained an aggressive seller of USD/JPY. Intervention on Thursday and Friday alone may have totalled close to \$80bn, exceeding the scale of operations seen in late April, and further intervention may have been conducted today. On the US side, reports suggest the Federal Reserve was checking rates in EUR/JPY and may have been selling euros against the yen, although it remains unclear whether US authorities have also been directly

selling USD/JPY.

Questions also remain over the scale of US participation. *Reuters* published a photograph of Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent's handwritten notes referencing plans to purchase \$5-10bn of yen. In practice, we suspect the amounts deployed may prove smaller. Unlike Japan, the US holds only limited foreign exchange reserves, meaning the signalling effect of intervention is likely to matter more than the volume of flows.

The US holds roughly \$38bn of foreign currency reserves, split broadly evenly between the Treasury's Exchange Stabilization Fund (ESF) and the Federal Reserve's System Open Market Account (SOMA). Around 70% of those reserves are held in euros, with the remainder invested in yen-denominated assets.

Q: Why now?

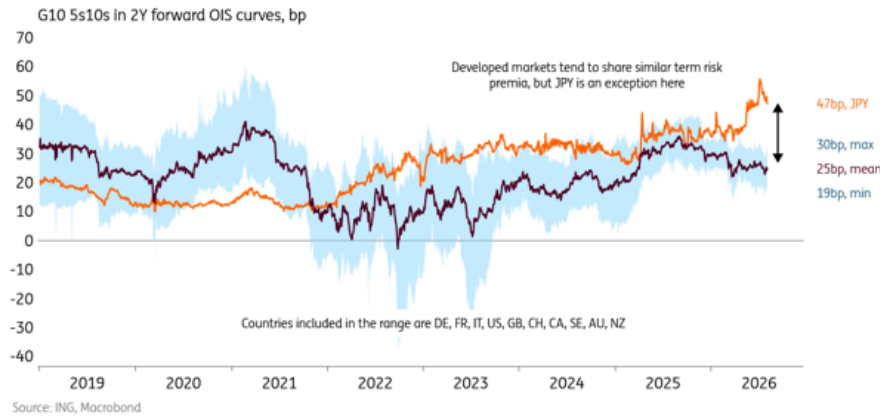
Joint intervention has not come as a complete surprise since the Fed did check the USD/JPY rate back in January. Bessent has been supportive of Japanese intervention for a while and has acknowledged that the yen is very undervalued.

Perhaps Washington felt that Tokyo required some help with the heavy-lifting of the yen, since April/May's \$70bn of FX sales had failed to prevent USD/JPY from trading to a new high at 164. That yen weakness was seen contributing to Japan's 30% year-on-year increase in import prices and, in turn, weighing on JGBs.

Also, in the rates space, the nervousness from investors about Japan has been mounting since the start of the year. The 10Y JGB is trading at the highest yield since the 90s and the momentum is clearly there to move higher still. And this is not just an inflation story – real rates rose more rapidly over the past year than break-evens.

Instead, we argue that investors are also increasingly demanding a risk premium to hold JPY rates, adding upward pressure to 10Y JGB yields. In the figure below, you can see that the slopes (in 2Y forwards) of most G10 currency swap curves tend to trade very closely together, especially in recent years. The JPY curve is the exception here. The much steeper curve is evidence that investors are demanding a higher return for exposures to Japanese rates.

Investors are demanding an increased term risk premium for holding JPY rates



Source: ING, Macrobond

Did Washington feel that the JGB sell-off was undermining Treasuries as well? The higher risk premium of JPY does not immediately trigger large spillovers to markets abroad, but the selling of UST holdings by Japan would pose a more material risk. Japan is one of the largest foreign investors with holdings of around \$1.1tr. However, there have been reports today that Japan could use the Fed's FIMA repo facility to raise intervention dollars against its Treasury collateral, rather than selling those securities. Yet, the single counterparty limit there is \$60bn, which could be quickly consumed.

When looking at historical flows data, we see that Japanese investors tend to buy USTs when relative FX-hedged yields are attractive. With a steeper JPY curve, the relative value turns away from USTs, in favour of JGBs. With the record US deficit unlikely to be addressed anytime soon, foreign buyers will need to play an important role to prevent UST yields from breaking higher.

Q: Will the US try to get the rest of G7 and G20 on side?

For now, intervention remains a bilateral US-Japan operation. A more powerful signal would come from broader G7 or G20 backing. The next opportunity arrives at the G20 Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors meeting in Asheville, North Carolina, from 31 August to 1 September, where Washington could seek wider endorsement for efforts to stabilise the yen.

We think the chances of securing explicit multilateral support are low. The challenge is that many G20 members are likely to view yen weakness not as a case of market dysfunction, but as the consequence of Japan's own policy mix. Loose fiscal policy, still-accommodative monetary settings and the Takaichi government's growth agenda have all contributed to a weak yen environment. Against that backdrop, other countries may be reluctant to commit political capital or market credibility to a coordinated campaign to strengthen the currency.

Indeed, a formal G20 statement backing yen appreciation would be difficult to reconcile with the longstanding G20 principle that exchange rates should be market-determined. While policymakers may endorse efforts to address excessive volatility or disorderly market conditions, explicit support for a stronger yen appears a much higher hurdle.

Q: Does this represent a new era of US FX activism in global financial markets?

Confirmation of US Treasury purchases of yen would come less than a year after Washington's intervention to support the Argentine peso. In October 2025, the Treasury extended a \$20bn ESF-backed swap facility to Argentina and subsequently used the Exchange Stabilization Fund to help stabilise the peso ahead of the country's mid-term elections. Argentina ultimately drew around \$2.5bn from the facility and repaid the amount in full before year-end.

Taken together, the Argentine and Japanese episodes suggest a Treasury that is becoming more willing to use the ESF in support of broader economic and geopolitical objectives. That marks a notable departure from the relative passivity that has characterised US foreign exchange policy for much of the last two decades.

The comparison should not be taken too far. Argentina was facing an acute balance-of-payments challenge and severe pressure on its currency, whereas Japan remains one of the world's largest creditor nations. If anything, Washington's willingness to support the yen reflects a view that the currency has moved substantially below levels justified by economic fundamentals. On that point, we share Bessent's view that the yen remains materially undervalued.

Q: Will intervention be successful?

With his long experience in currency markets, Bessent will appreciate that macro fundamentals ultimately dominate exchange rates. FX intervention can smooth disorderly market conditions and alter market psychology at the margin, but its primary function is typically to buy time rather than engineer a lasting shift in trend.

Japan's intervention campaign in the summer of 2024 illustrates the point. Those operations proved effective not because of their size alone, but because they coincided with a genuine turn in the US rate cycle as softer economic data paved the way for three 25bp Federal Reserve rate cuts later that year.

The same lesson applies today. The success of this latest intervention effort will depend less on how many yen authorities purchase and more on whether US economic data soften sufficiently to prevent further Fed tightening. That remains ING's central view and underpins our forecast for USD/JPY to decline to 158 by year-end and 152 by end-2027.

Those looking for an aggressive Bank of Japan tightening cycle to reinforce yen strength may be disappointed. The Takaichi government's emphasis on growth suggests the BoJ will remain cautious in withdrawing accommodation. In our view, more promising support for the yen could come from policies designed to redirect domestic savings back into Japanese assets.

This is where developments around NISA merit close attention. The 2024 NISA reforms encouraged substantial retail investment into overseas equities, contributing to persistent capital outflows and a weaker yen. Any future adjustments that broaden the appeal of domestic assets, including greater access to instruments such as JGBs, could help reverse some of those flows.

Ultimately, intervention can create an inflection point, but it cannot overturn fundamentals. A sustained move lower in USD/JPY will require narrower US-Japan rate differentials and a softer US economic backdrop. Without that, even coordinated intervention risks being remembered as another attempt to slow the dollar's rise rather than reverse it.

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Article | 3 August 2026

UNITED STATES

Webinar: What if... The Fed cuts rates by next summer?

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- How Kevin Warsh is reshaping the Federal Reserve
- Why the Fed could cut rates in 2027
- What ING's call for the Fed means for the dollar

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Details

Date: Thursday 6 August

Time: 1400 BST/1500 CEST/0900 ET

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Note: If you registered for or attended our recent webinar on oil prices, you'll automatically be signed up for this event and future events in our What if? series. Add it to your calendar by following the instructions [on this page](#)

Speakers

- **James Smith** (Developed Markets Economist)
- **James Knightley** (Chief International Economist)
- **Francesco Pesole** (FX Strategist)

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SUSTAINABILITY

Global sustainable finance 2026: growth on the horizon

Resilient issuance keeps the global sustainable debt market on track for growth in 2026, despite geopolitical uncertainty, policy shifts and pockets of saturation. But the ingredients to the '[sustainable debt cocktail](#)' are still changing, with some products and regions seeing stronger momentum



We expect the global sustainable debt market to grow in 2026 but we see divergences among regions and products

Growth set to return despite regional divergence

At the halfway mark of the year, we still [expect](#) the global sustainable finance market to return to growth for the full year, surpassing 2025 levels after a modest decline in 2025 from 2024.

Global sustainable debt issuance (excluding asset-backed securities, or ABS) totalled \$846bn in the first half of 2026. Although this is a bit lower than the first-half issuances in 2025, it remains comfortably within the healthy \$800bn-900bn range recorded in the first halves since 2022. That shows considerable market resilience, especially given the ongoing Middle East tensions and subdued sustainability policy environment in the US.

Looking at the full year of 2026, we expect resilience to yield growth, with the global sustainable finance market reaching \$1,621bn of issuance. This will be driven by many factors:

- Middle East tensions make a stronger case for enhanced energy security, affordability,

and industrial competitiveness in Europe through clean energy buildout.

- The rush to build AI-driven data centres – and the growing scrutiny of their sustainability – is expected to drive sustainable debt issuance in the sector globally.
- The consequent need to enhance digital and power infrastructure to support AI development and electrification will spur sustainable financing.
- Many corporates remain committed to decarbonisation and managing climate risk.
- Governments are further leveraging sustainable finance as a tool to fund decarbonisation efforts.
- Regulation and standardisation provide clarity and ease.

Global sustainable debt issuance, historical and forecast

\$bn

	Bonds					Loans					Total
	Green	Sustaina-bility	Social	Sust-linked	Transition	Green	Sustaina-bility	Social	Sust-linked	Transition	
2020	290.4	181.3	155.1	10.9	2.3	93.2	0.0	0.2	143.0	0.3	876.7
2021	601.6	249.3	237.2	109.2	3.8	117.8	4.7	0.1	530.1	0.1	1,853.8
2022	553.0	193.3	154.7	88.0	3.3	138.9	6.2	7.3	474.6	0.5	1,619.8
2023	611.7	202.5	155.9	70.0	2.8	164.6	12.4	4.4	244.4	0.6	1,469.3
2024	648.3	256.3	170.2	39.1	20.9	216.6	9.2	9.3	295.9	2.0	1,667.8
2025	669.2	271.5	138.6	33.3	11.7	247.8	19.4	8.5	139.5	0.0	1,539.4
2026F	700.0	290.0	150.0	25.0	15.0	255.0	15.0	9.0	160.0	2.0	1,621.0

Source: ING Research, Bloomberg New Energy Finance (BloombergNEF). Note: Issuance data excludes asset-backed securities (ABS).

We stand by these forecasts for the year, as we already see most segments beyond the halfway point in terms of reaching these targets. The public market side, in particular, has 55-60% of the forecast already issued.

While the private market side appears to be lagging, we note that there may be some under-reporting within the private market side, and these figures may not reflect full issuance levels.

Global sustainable issuance in the first half of 2026 as a % of full-year forecast

\$bn



Source: ING Research, BloombergNEF. Note: Issuance data excludes ABS.

Nevertheless, as noted in our [market outlook](#) in February, our expectations continue to vary across regions.

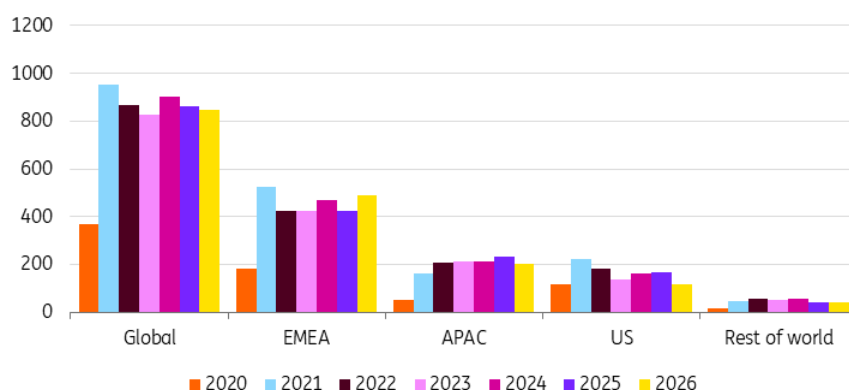
EMEA is leading sustainable debt issuance in 2026. Issuance in both the first and second quarters exceeded 2025 levels, driving a strong first half of the year. Much of this growth came from the public sector, with government agencies, sovereigns, and supranationals issuing a record \$245bn in the first half – 50% higher than in 2025. Financial institutions also contributed to the momentum, increasing issuance by 36% year-over-year (YoY).

In **APAC**, issuance levels have been mostly steady over the past five years, despite first-half 2026 volumes being slightly lower than in 2025. That small dip is mainly due to softer issuance from financial institutions following a record first half in 2025. Even so, APAC is well positioned for growth, with both governments and companies continuing to advance decarbonisation goals through sustainable financing.

In the **US**, policy uncertainty continues to weigh on sustainable financing. First-half 2026 issuance was about 40% lower than in both 2024 and 2025, although it remained slightly above 2020 levels. Data centres, renewable energy, and related infrastructure have emerged as the engine of sustainable financing. We expect these sectors to maintain momentum through 2026 and 2027. For data centres, however, growing scrutiny of community impacts could lead to more selective, but ultimately higher-quality, sustainable debt issuance.

Sustainable debt issuance by region in the first half of each year

\$bn



Source: ING Research, BloombergNEF. Note: Issuance data excludes ABS.

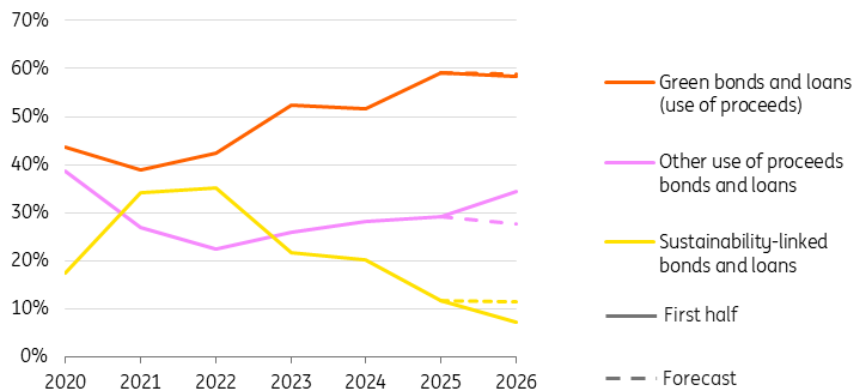
Green bonds and loans are still king

By product type, we expect green bonds and green loans to remain dominant in the global sustainable debt market, together accounting for around 60% of total issuance this year, up from 50% in 2024 and 40% in 2021. This reflects growing market preference for green use-of-proceeds instruments as credible tools for financing environmental projects.

Beyond green instruments, some other use-of-proceeds products, namely social bonds and sustainability bonds, also saw higher first-half issuances YoY, despite accounting for a much smaller market share.

Sustainability-linked bond and loan issuance remained under pressure in the first half of 2026, declining 54% YoY to just over \$60bn. Their market share has fallen from 35% in 2022 to just over 10% in 2025, as issuers with green investment plans increasingly opt for green instruments. However, as noted in our previous outlook, sustainability-linked loan volumes are likely understated, as some private transactions may not be captured in sustainable debt databases. Despite accounting for only 7% of issuance in the first half of 2026, we expect the share of sustainability-linked debt to stabilise above 10% for the year.

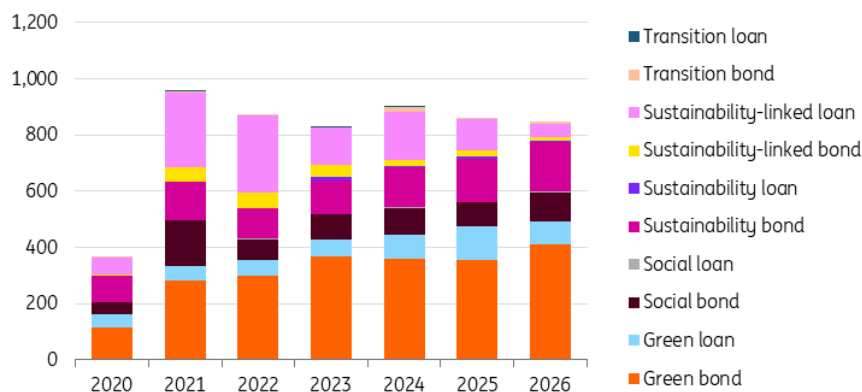
Share of sustainable debt products in total global issuance



Source: ING Research, BloombergNEF. Note: Issuance data excludes ABS.

Global sustainable debt issuance by product in the first half of each year

\$bn



Source: ING Research, BloombergNEF. Note: Issuance data excludes ABS.

Corporates to remain soft as public issuances pick up

Issuances from non-financial corporates have continued to weaken in 2026. First-half issuance totalled \$250bn, the lowest level since 2021. The slowdown was driven largely by weaker-than-expected issuance from European corporates, alongside an anticipated decline in the US amid policy uncertainty.

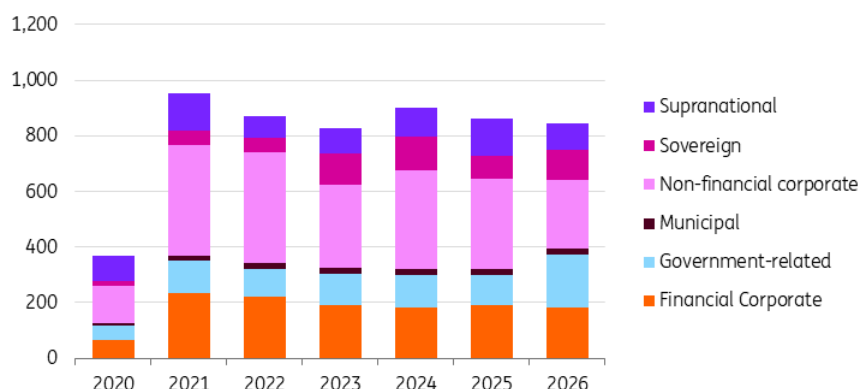
In Europe, the weakness may reflect a slightly saturated sustainable debt market, mixed with an environment of ease of issuance in general and a lack of economic benefit for going green (i.e. no 'greenium' at this time). This is temporary, as, historically in times of higher volatility within markets, it's the sustainable bond products that outperform and hold firmer. Naturally,

standardisation will continue to keep sustainable issuance effort-free, and the likes of the Green Bond Standard, while not intended to be adopted by all issuers, continue to drive high-quality issuance.

In contrast, issuances from government agencies rose 73% YoY in the first half of 2026. The biggest contributor to that increase is a record \$58bn of issuance from German state-owned investment and development bank KfW, with its second-highest first-half issuance being \$25bn. The bank has an ambition of investing in competitiveness through environmental action. In APAC, governments in Australia and Mainland China also saw issuance increases.

Global sustainable debt issuance by issuer type in the first half of each year

\$bn



Source: ING Research, BloombergNEF. Note: Issuance data excludes ABS.

For the rest of 2026, we expect the public sector to be the primary driver of global sustainable debt issuance. Corporate issuance is likely to remain soft and end the year below 2025 levels. However, corporates still have significant sustainable financing needs, as strategic segments such as AI data centres, digitalisation, innovation, and critical infrastructure will increasingly demand energy efficiency and decarbonisation.

There would also be growing regulatory and stakeholder focus on data centre sustainability. The EU is mandating energy reporting and green financing rules for data centres, while actively developing performance standards and efficiency labels. In the US, growing scrutiny of data centres' environmental footprint could lead to a more disciplined approach to sustainable finance.

Conclusion

We expect global sustainable debt issuance to stay relatively strong throughout 2026,

supporting our forecast for a return to market growth this year. However, regional, product and issuer dynamics continue to diverge. The sustainable debt cocktail is poised to get bigger, but its ingredients are still evolving.

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3 August 2026
Credit Strategy

Supply for July (US\$bn)

	Corporates	Financials
July	83	65

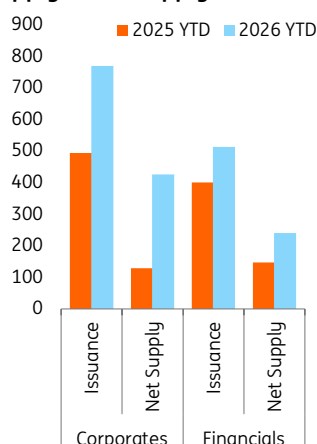
Source: ING, Dealogic

Supply FY and YTD (US\$bn)

Corporates	FY	YTD
2020	1168	851
2021	730	463
2022	565	374
2023	650	468
2024	813	541
2025	926	494
2026	770	770
Financials	FY	YTD
2020	530	367
2021	642	384
2022	629	453
2023	546	334
2024	704	479
2025	749	496
2026	604	604

Source: ING, IGM, Dealogic

Supply & Net Supply YTD



Source: ING, IGM, Dealogic

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US Dollar Credit Supply

July supply stays strong despite summer period



Strong USD Corporate supply defies the summer lull

- USD corporate supply eased to US\$82.6bn in July from US\$110.7bn in June but was almost three times July 2025's US\$28.5bn. YTD supply reached US\$769.7bn, 56% ahead of last year and second only to 2020. July redemptions of US\$30bn left net supply at US\$52.6bn, lifting the YTD total to US\$425.9bn. Tight spreads, fund inflows and attractive all-in yields continue to support demand.
- TMT dominated July with US\$27.7bn and remains the standout YTD driver at US\$294.6bn, up 206% YoY, reflecting substantial technology funding and capex needs. Utilities added US\$11.3bn and are up 35% YTD, while Healthcare and Industrials are up 122% and 38%. Consumer and Autos lag at -54% and -26%, while Oil & Gas saw no July issuance.
- Reverse Yankees added €5.2bn, lifting YTD supply to €74.1bn and diverting some US issuance into euros mostly in the TMT space. The EUR cost advantage is increasingly issuer- and maturity-dependent as USD spreads tighten. USD corporate ESG issuance added US\$0.7bn, taking YTD supply to US\$8.8bn from US\$2.5bn last year, but still well below the US\$12-22bn recorded over the same period in 2022-24.

Banks' USD denominated bond supply remains stable in July

- Despite the summer period kicking-in, banks remained active on the USD-denominated bond primary market with just over US\$55bn issued. That's only US\$4bn below what we recorded in June and a good US\$15bn ahead of the July 2025 total. Last month's activity brings the USD bank bond supply to US\$471bn in 2026 YTD.
- While we note a slight drop in the senior unsecured and capital segments, covered bond issuances remained stable last month with US\$2bn printed by a Canadian issuer.
- When accounting for all segments of the liability structure, these sustained supply levels allowed the net supply to, not only, remain well in positive territory with US\$27bn, but also stand higher than in June.
- Looking at sustainable issuances, we note a decline in banks' supply with less than US\$1bn printed last month. Alongside the dip, we also record a shift in issuers' preference as, for the first time since February, no green bonds were issued but activity is recorded in the social and sustainable formats. Despite July's decline in sustainable bank bond supply, the YTD level remains well ahead of last year with US\$9.6bn issued, up from the US\$5.4bn in 2025 YTD.

Fig 1 USD corporate supply overview (US\$bn)

	2022	2023	2024	2025	2025 Jul	2026 Jun	2026 Jul	2025 YTD	2026 YTD	% diff
Auto	29	41	59	47	-	1	4	34	25	-26%
Consumer	63	95	84	105	6	2	1	85	39	-54%
Healthcare	72	114	131	104	-	-	5	39	86	122%
Industrial & Chemicals	89	91	115	100	7	26	5	67	93	38%
Real Estate	26	32	41	45	2	2	7	26	25	-3%
TMT	137	92	125	244	7	41	28	96	295	206%
Utility	100	129	148	160	3	27	11	92	125	35%
Oil & Gas	21	34	72	58	2	4	-	31	32	3%
Others	28	22	39	64	2	7	22	24	51	111%

Source: ING, Dealogic

Note: USD supply numbers include just IG corporates from America and Europe.

Fig 2 USD financial supply overview (US\$bn)

	2022	2023	2024	2025	2025 Jul	2026 Jun	2026 Jul	2025 YTD	2026 YTD	% diff
Banks	514	452	512	542	41	59	55	386	472	22%
of which SNP	395	326	343	352	14	31	43	249	309	24%
of which SP	35	58	72	75	12	15	2	59	72	22%
of which Capital	56	50	91	101	15	10	9	67	78	16%
of which Covered	28	18	5	13	0	2	2	10	12	22%
Finance	67	56	120	134	12	22	19	69	93	35%
Insurance	48	38	73	70	3	8	2	42	39	-6%

Source: ING, IGM, Dealogic

Fig 3 USD corporate supply and net supply by month (US\$bn)

Issuance	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
2022	34.1	45.8	125.7	45.0	44.8	35.2	25.0	51.7	44.9	41.2	65.4	6.0	564.9
2023	47.9	129.0	68.1	31.7	124.3	33.6	28.4	35.7	49.5	27.3	62.6	11.5	649.7
2024	73.5	138.9	82.0	51.4	77.7	58.3	51.1	91.7	88.7	40.6	40.2	19.0	813.1
2025	57.1	97.6	131.8	47.0	74.7	57.4	28.5	77.2	122.2	102.3	108.1	22.6	926.5
2026	56.2	144.4	178.7	99.3	97.8	110.7	82.6						769.7
Net Supply	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
2022	2.8	5.3	69.3	19.1	-8.7	-15.4	-3.2	2.9	4.2	6.4	19.3	-22.9	79.1
2023	9.8	82.0	1.0	-19.9	66.4	-20.5	0.4	1.6	-5.9	3.6	21.1	-15.8	123.7
2024	45.1	94.1	18.9	12.3	34.6	15.7	24.3	51.1	50.3	9.0	-4.7	-6.2	344.5
2025	33.0	63.2	61.1	-12.5	-7.9	-0.8	-7.3	44.6	84.7	61.2	58.8	0.1	378.1
Redemptions	39.3	73.2	74.7	40.9	39.3	46.5	30.0	44.0	42.9	28.7	39.8	27.1	526.2
2026	16.8	71.2	104.0	58.5	58.5	64.2	52.6						425.9

Redemptions shown for 2026 only

Source: ING, Dealogic

Fig 4 USD financial supply and net supply by month (US\$bn)

Issuance	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
2022	104.0	41.1	101.5	59.4	51.9	31.9	63.1	53.4	29.8	46.2	40.7	6.7	629.4
2023	86.0	35.4	28.3	36.3	32.2	58.4	56.7	30.6	74.1	49.1	47.8	10.9	545.7
2024	107.0	63.9	63.4	54.8	64.8	43.0	82.6	18.0	73.0	62.9	59.2	11.7	704.1
2025	139.9	61.6	48.2	57.9	83.0	49.6	55.8	33.9	78.4	91.6	30.9	18.3	749.1
2026	150.9	51.4	60.8	96.3	79.8	89.2	75.4						603.7
Net Supply	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
2022	23.5	26.6	63.9	19.8	26.6	-9.7	27.1	30.3	-15.4	6.9	19.1	-58.0	160.7
2023	54.6	21.4	-0.6	23.8	7.0	31.9	35.9	21.7	44.5	34.0	37.9	-9.3	302.7
2024	62.2	42.6	14.4	18.4	32.0	13.2	56.0	-1.9	30.3	22.4	28.6	-8.0	310.1
2025	81.9	16.3	10.2	-0.7	53.0	0.9	8.2	1.5	29.4	69.6	7.7	-4.3	273.6
Redemptions	88.2	15.2	44.2	44.4	29.4	50.3	35.8	29.4	49.8	51.1	28.0	60.3	525.9
2026	62.8	36.2	16.6	51.8	50.4	38.9	39.6						296.3

Redemptions shown for 2026 only

Source: ING, IGM, Dealogic

Fig 5 Corporate supply and redemptions by month, 2026 (US\$bn)

Supply	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Auto	5.7	0.0	9.2	1.4	3.5	1.3	3.9						24.9
Consumer	0.2	10.2	8.8	6.9	10.1	2.1	0.5						38.7
Healthcare	0.0	40.8	15.5	3.5	21.5	0.0	5.0						86.3
Industrial	7.4	7.6	31.6	6.9	9.1	26.1	4.5						93.1
Real Estate	1.4	7.2	2.4	2.9	1.2	2.3	7.4						24.8
TMT	23.0	49.4	78.5	57.2	18.2	40.8	27.7						294.6
Utility	11.6	23.4	18.1	9.8	23.0	27.4	11.3						124.5
Oil & Gas	7.0	1.5	9.3	3.0	6.8	4.2	0.0						31.7
Others	0.0	4.4	5.5	7.9	4.4	6.5	22.3						51.0
Redemptions	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Auto	5.4	0.0	6.1	4.8	0.4	1.3	2.0	5.0	1.4	0.8	4.6	2.8	34.3
Consumer	6.3	23.9	6.4	7.3	1.0	10.2	7.6	5.1	7.1	5.1	8.2	1.7	89.8
Healthcare	1.5	5.8	13.3	1.2	8.9	7.5	1.7	3.2	3.1	0.9	10.5	3.8	61.2
Industrial	7.4	12.2	8.5	8.6	7.4	6.5	1.2	3.9	6.9	2.8	7.9	4.0	77.4
Real Estate	3.1	4.1	1.3	3.1	2.1	2.3	3.2	2.4	2.5	6.0	3.1	1.6	34.7
TMT	1.4	20.6	22.6	7.3	9.2	10.5	5.8	16.8	11.5	7.4	2.1	2.7	117.8
Utility	8.2	1.9	4.8	3.4	3.4	4.3	4.8	4.7	5.6	3.2	1.2	5.9	51.4
Oil & Gas	3.1	2.7	9.7	2.5	5.3	0.1	1.5	2.0	2.8	1.0	1.8	3.5	36.1
Others	3.0	2.1	2.0	2.8	1.8	3.8	2.2	0.9	1.9	1.6	0.5	1.1	23.7

Source: ING, Dealogic

Fig 6 Financial supply and redemptions by month, 2026 (US\$bn)

Supply	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Banks	133.7	34.4	45.7	79.8	63.9	59.1	55.1						471.5
of which SNP	91.4	26.0	23.4	61.8	32.4	31.4	42.8						309.1
of which SP	19.9	1.3	13.3	1.2	19.7	15.3	1.8						72.3
of which Capital	22.5	7.1	5.5	12.8	11.1	10.5	8.6						77.9
of which Covered	0.0	0.0	3.5	4.0	0.7	2.0	2.0						12.2
Finance	8.1	13.8	11.9	10.9	7.1	22.9	18.7						93.4
Insurance	9.1	3.2	3.2	5.6	8.8	7.9	1.6						39.4
Redemptions	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Banks	72.7	8.8	31.8	33.4	16.6	37.3	28.0	18.5	40.2	40.0	17.8	54.1	399.0
of which SNP	67.2	8.2	23.9	30.7	10.1	29.3	21.9	17.0	30.7	30.6	12.8	47.0	329.2
of which SP	4.0	0.0	0.8	0.0	0.0	1.6	2.7	0.5	0.8	1.8	1.0	0.0	13.1
of which Capital	1.5	0.0	6.8	2.8	6.2	2.5	1.5	1.0	3.5	3.4	2.5	4.5	36.0
of which Covered	0.0	0.6	0.4	0.0	0.3	4.0	2.0	0.0	5.3	4.3	1.5	2.6	20.9
Finance	11.1	5.9	8.7	3.5	9.9	8.1	5.1	7.6	6.0	9.5	7.0	2.5	85.0
Insurance	4.4	0.5	3.7	7.5	2.8	4.9	2.7	3.1	3.2	1.6	3.2	3.7	41.0

Source: ING, IGM, Dealogic

Fig 7 USD supply, redemptions and net supply by year (US\$bn)

Corporates	YTD	FY	Reds	Net	Financials	YTD	FY	Reds	Net
2015	482.6	709.3	256.5	452.7	2015	276.5	422.3	246.5	175.8
2016	475.6	697.4	293.4	404.0	2016	264.5	395.7	237.2	158.5
2017	450.0	743.8	355.7	388.1	2017	305.2	425.2	267.3	157.9
2018	386.0	651.5	382.7	268.8	2018	300.9	437.2	283.4	153.8
2019	407.2	700.8	429.9	270.9	2019	236.5	364.3	263.2	101.1
2020	851.5	1168.4	453.3	715.1	2020	367.0	530.2	306.6	223.6
2021	462.6	729.9	478.7	251.2	2021	384.4	642.4	337.3	305.1
2022	373.5	564.9	485.8	79.1	2022	452.7	629.4	468.8	160.7
2023	468.3	649.7	526.0	123.7	2023	333.3	545.7	243.0	302.7
2024	541.5	813.1	468.5	344.5	2024	479.4	704.1	394.0	310.1
2025	494.1	926.5	548.3	378.1	2025	496.0	749.1	475.5	273.6
2026	769.7	769.7	526.2		2026	603.7	603.7	525.1	
2027			554.3		2027			394.8	
2028			608.7		2028			446.9	

Source: ING, IGM, Dealogic

Fig 8 Subordinated supply. 2026 and 2025 (US\$bn)

2026	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
AT1	8.6	4.6	5.5	8.0	7.1	5.9	4.8						44.3
T2	13.9	2.5	0.0	4.8	4.0	4.5	3.8						33.5
Bank Capital	22.5	7.1	5.5	12.8	11.1	10.4	8.6						77.8
2025	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
AT1	9.6	11.3	0.5	3.7	2.7	3.5	10.3	1.1	9.7	2.3	3.5	4.1	62.0
T2	6.7	4.0	3.7	0.8	0.5	5.5	4.8	4.3	4.8	1.5	1.8	1.4	39.8
Bank Capital	16.3	15.3	4.2	4.5	3.2	9.0	15.1	5.4	14.5	3.8	5.3	5.5	101.8

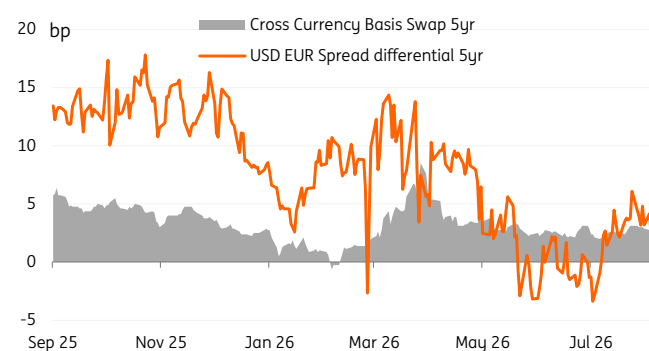
Source: ING, IGM, Dealogic

Fig 9 Reverse Yankee supply. 2026 and 2025 (\$bn)

2026	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Corporate	4.2	12.1	24.2	5.3	18.5	4.7	5.2						74.1
Financial	5.1	11.6	0.3	1.4	1.8	2.9	5.0						28.0
Total	9.2	23.7	24.5	6.7	20.3	7.6	10.2						102.1
2025	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Corporate	2.5	16.2	3.4	10.2	11.2	6.7	5.4	0.6	7.5	1.4	25.6	1.8	92.2
Financial	8.6	1.4	5.1	10.7	2.9	3.6	4.8	1.5	1.8	6.1	13.0	2.8	62.1
Total	11.1	17.6	8.5	20.8	14.1	10.3	10.2	2.1	9.3	7.5	38.6	4.5	154.3

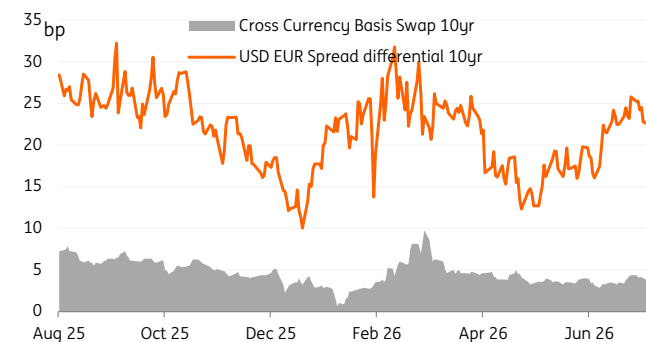
Source: ING, Dealogic

Fig 10 XCCY 5yr



Source: ING, IHS Markit, Refinitiv

Fig 11 XCCY 10yr



Source: ING, IHS Markit, Refinitiv

Fig 12 US. Yankee and Reverse Yankee supply (US\$bn)

Corporates	Domestic	Yankee	Rev Yankee (\$)	Financials	Domestic	Yankee	Rev Yankee (\$)
2015	610.3	108.5	62.7	2015	302.8	127.1	28.9
2016	589.1	113.9	65.8	2016	282.5	114.0	45.6
2017	654.9	103.2	65.7	2017	312.8	111.9	35.6
2018	523.8	131.2	32.0	2018	306.7	131.7	18.4
2019	610.1	96.6	98.3	2019	269.7	95.8	29.2
2020	1031.2	152.3	68.9	2020	406.9	125.3	25.3
2021	628.3	108.4	64.5	2021	363.9	278.4	41.5
2022	486.3	90.6	34.0	2022	342.0	287.5	29.8
2023	559.8	106.1	44.0	2023	267.8	278.0	13.1
2024	688.6	144.2	65.3	2024	253.4	109.5	27.0
2025	794.7	145.8	92.2	2025	282.4	118.7	62.1
2026	681.3	106.6	74.1	2026	386.9	265.1	28.0

Source: ING, IGM

Fig 13 ESG supply per month 2026 (US\$bn)

Corporate	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Green	0.5	1.6	0.0	4.6	0.5	1.0	0.7						8.8
Social	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0						0.0
Sustainable	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0						0.0
ESG	0.5	1.6	0.0	4.6	0.5	1.0	0.7						8.8
Financial	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Green	1.0	0.0	0.8	0.5	1.5	1.3	0.0						5.1
Social	1.0	0.5	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.6						2.1
Sustainable	1.6	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.5	0.0	0.3						2.4
ESG	3.6	0.5	0.8	0.5	2.0	1.3	0.9						9.6

Source: ING, IGM, Dealogic

Fig 14 ESG supply per year and YTD (US\$bn)

Corporate	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	2022 YTD	2023 YTD	2024 YTD	2025 YTD	2026 YTD
Green	25.1	13.2	21.1	7.1	8.8	17.1	10.7	19.1	2.5	8.8
Social	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.0
Sustainable	4.9	1.3	0.0	0.0	0.0	4.9	1.3	0.0	0.0	0.0
ESG	30.0	14.6	21.1	7.1	8.8	22.1	12.1	19.1	2.5	8.8
Financial	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	2022 YTD	2023 YTD	2024 YTD	2025 YTD	2026 YTD
Green	13.1	27.5	4.5	5.7	5.1	10.5	12.4	2.7	2.0	5.1
Social	3.6	6.3	5.5	4.1	2.1	3.6	2.8	2.0	2.3	2.1
Sustainable	8.7	7.9	10.9	2.2	2.4	4.0	1.6	9.1	1.1	2.4
ESG	25.4	41.7	20.9	11.9	9.6	18.1	16.8	13.8	5.4	9.6

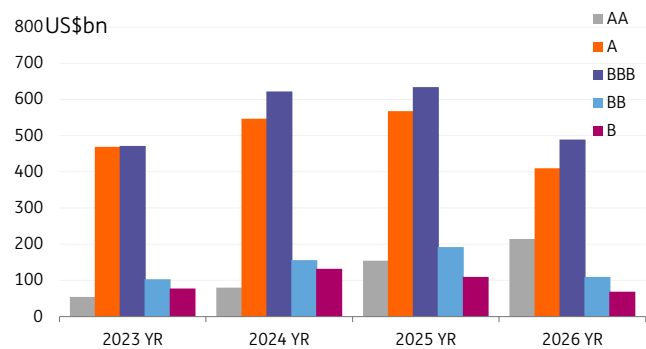
Source: ING, IGM, Dealogic

Fig 15 Corporates and banks issuance by maturity, 2026 and 2025 (US\$bn)

2026	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	2026
Corp 0-3yr	5.6	18.1	43.7	5.6	16.2	9.7	9.9						108.8
Corp 3-6yr	16.2	24.7	29.0	13.4	22.0	25.8	17.6						148.6
Corp 6-9yr	8.5	18.9	20.8	8.7	10.5	14.3	10.9						92.5
Corp 9-12yr	15.1	37.5	41.8	30.9	26.2	26.3	15.7						193.4
Corp 12-17yr	0.6	4.4	0.2	4.6	1.5	6.6	1.1						19.0
Corp 17yrs+	10.3	40.8	43.2	36.2	21.3	28.0	27.5						207.3
Bank 0-3yr	4.2	0.0	0.0	0	1.8	1.7	0						7.7
Bank 3-6yr	45.9	6.8	22.0	30.3	31	25.1	19.2						180.3
Bank 6-9yr	27.5	9.2	11.0	22.1	16.3	14.7	14.1						114.9
Bank 9-12yr	34.8	7.5	4.8	18.3	6	9.6	10.1						91.1
Bank 12-17yr	6.3	2.8	0.0	0	1.3	0	3.5						13.9
Bank 17yrs+	15.1	6.4	8.0	9.2	7.6	7.4	8.3						62.0
2025	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	2025
Corp 0-3yr	6.7	17.0	27.4	6.1	8.7	8.5	1.5	9.4	12.4	7.6	12.2	0.9	118.2
Corp 3-6yr	14.0	16.9	23.0	17.2	18.2	14.2	9.8	14.2	26.5	12.3	23.5	5.1	194.7
Corp 6-9yr	5.2	10.6	14.6	3.1	10.0	5.4	3.9	10.5	14.6	12.0	11.4	3.2	104.5
Corp 9-12yr	19.6	30.0	40.4	14.9	25.7	19.2	10.8	26.3	33.2	20.1	29.3	5.2	274.8
Corp 12-17yr	0.6	2.2	1.0	1.1	0.0	2.0	0.1	1.6	3.2	1.6	1.1	0.2	14.6
Corp 17yrs+	11.0	20.9	25.5	4.7	12.2	8.2	2.3	15.3	32.3	48.7	30.6	8.1	219.7
Bank 0-3yr	0.0	0.8	0.0	1.3	7.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.8	9.8
Bank 3-6yr	45.0	13.4	22.2	16.1	27.2	18.3	13.3	7.3	18.9	16.5	6.8	3.4	208.4
Bank 6-9yr	27.8	10.9	3.4	14.5	20.2	6.1	9.8	0.5	13.4	16.4	5.0	1.0	128.8
Bank 9-12yr	27.3	11.1	4.8	11.8	6.8	8.4	7.3	6.9	12.8	20.5	2.0	1.4	120.8
Bank 12-17yr	0.0	0.0	1.8	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	1.8	0.0	0.4	0.0	3.9
Bank 17yrs+	13.4	13.3	1.8	3.7	3.2	4.0	10.3	2.4	9.7	2.3	4.7	4.1	72.6

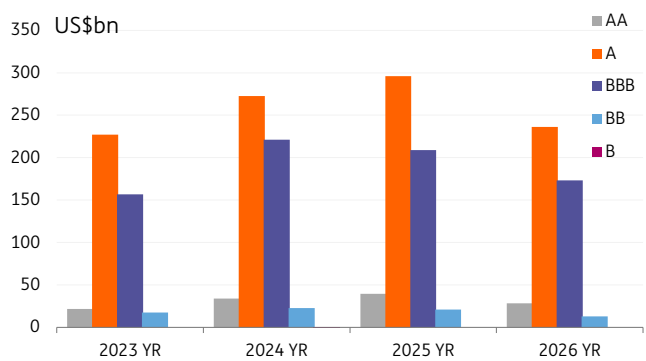
Source: ING, IGM, Dealogic

Fig 16 Corporate supply per S&P rating (US\$bn)



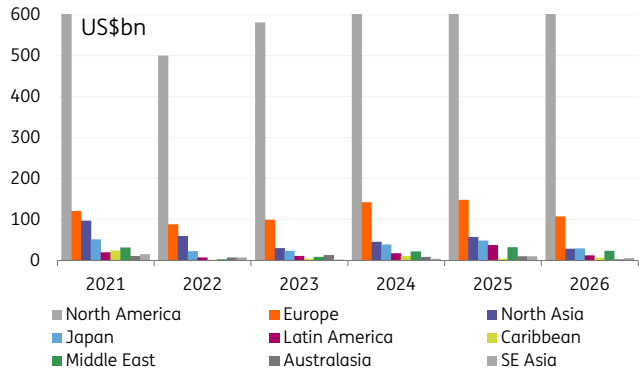
Source: ING, Dealogic

Fig 17 Financial supply per S&P rating (US\$bn)



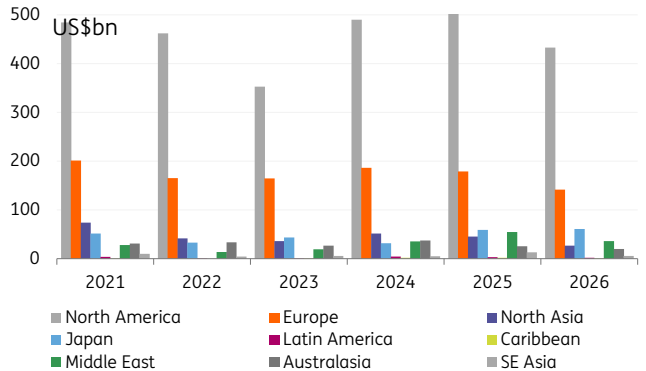
Source: ING, Dealogic

Fig 18 Corporate supply per country (US\$bn)



Source: ING, Dealogic

Fig 19 Financial supply per country (US\$bn)



Source: ING, Dealogic

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Article | 5 August 2026

FX

FX Daily: Bessent provides more rationale for yen intervention

Expectations of another ceasefire in the Gulf and lower oil prices have seen market rates drop and equities rally. A risk-on environment would normally see the dollar come lower, but uncertainty about Fed policy and a healthy US economy are keeping the dollar supported. US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent has provided more colour on FX intervention



US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent has shed more light on the recent joint intervention to support the yen

➔ USD: Dollar is holding up quite well

Financial markets are experiencing one of their periodic pro-risk turns. Reports suggest a new US-Iran ceasefire deal could be announced today, allowing traffic to transit the Strait of Hormuz for 60 days without a fee. Oil prices have been trading off that story all week, bringing Brent below \$80/bl and delivering lower market interest rates and higher equity prices around the world.

The above dynamic would normally be associated with a weaker dollar, as investors put money to work outside the US. But that's not quite the case. DXY dollar index continues to

trade near 100, which probably owes to lingering fears that the Fed might still hike on 16 September. Lower oil prices and perhaps some slightly softer JOLTS jobs data have seen pricing for that Fed move drop to +14bp from +16/17bp at the start of the week.

While Friday's US July jobs report is still the biggest macro driver this week, there will still be focus on today's ISM services release and the monthly ADP numbers. Regional surveys suggest the former should remain strong and an ADP release near consensus of +65k looks unlikely to hit the dollar too hard. Overall, we can probably see DXY trading in a tight 99.50-100.00 trading range today.

Elsewhere, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent yesterday provided some colour to the recent participation in joint intervention on the yen. One of his points, which we did not cover in our [review](#), was that yen weakness could trigger competitive devaluations in the region. This harks back to some of the hot topics in last year's [Mar-a-Lago accord](#) discussions, where undervalued Asian currencies were blamed for the hollowing out of the US manufacturing sector. His comments also seemed to imply a quid pro quo had been made with the Bank of Japan, where, in exchange for intervention, the BoJ would hike earlier than expected in September. Chances of an earlier BoJ hike have been marked sharply higher this week. USD/JPY may well have put in a significant top at 164, but cementing it will require both faster BoJ tightening and the Fed avoiding a hike.

Chris Turner

↑ **EUR: Lacklustre**

Despite better-than-expected hard eurozone data last week and a decent fall in energy prices this week, EUR/USD has struggled to make much headway on the upside. Perhaps that is a function of drought conditions in Europe and low water levels, which are hitting [industrial river traffic](#). Nevertheless, as a pro-growth currency, the global equity rally and buoyant investment trends should be helping the euro. Here, a move through 1.1550/60 today could open up 1.1615/20.

There may also be a case for a slightly stronger Swedish krona right now. The krona had been punished for the Riksbank's dovishness in a world of higher interest rates. This week's drop in energy and rates could see EUR/SEK correcting back to the 10.90 area.

Chris Turner

↓ **CZK: Lower inflation to ease CNB hike pricing**

July inflation in the Czech Republic is due today, and we expect headline CPI to rise from 1.5% to 1.7% year-on-year, mainly on higher fuel prices. However, core inflation will remain the key focus, as it was one of the reasons behind the Czech National Bank's June rate hike. The flash estimate offers limited detail, and unless inflation delivers a significant surprise, the market

impact should be limited given ongoing geopolitical developments and tomorrow's CNB meeting, where a new forecast will also be presented.

Our forecast of 1.7% headline inflation and 2.8% core inflation should ease hawkish market expectations and soften the CNB's hawkish rhetoric, which remains our baseline. The market is still pricing in two rate hikes, but unless inflation surprises to the upside, tomorrow's CNB meeting should deliver a more dovish outcome than current pricing implies. Together with lower oil prices, this should lead the market to price out at least one hike. That should put some pressure on the koruna, which has recently underperformed its CEE peers for the reasons outlined above, and we expect this trend to continue as market pricing turns more dovish. This should keep EUR/CZK closer to 24.200.

Frantisek Taborsky

BRL: Another 25bp rate cut expected from BACEN today

Brazil's central bank, BACEN, is widely expected to cut the policy rate by 25bp to 14.00% today. It feels that last year's 450bp rate hike to 15% did enough to slow inflation and is now unwinding that tightening. With Brazil's IPCA inflation running at 4.5% year-on-year, today's rate cut will still leave the real policy rate at a staggering 10% and will continue to encourage carry trade inflows into the Brazilian real.

Political risk in the form of Brazil's presidential election in October poses the biggest risk to the real. Neither candidate, President Lula nor Flavio Bolsonaro, seems serious about fiscal austerity. Yet investors are offered substantial compensation for holding the Brazilian real, and we expect it to continue outperforming the steep USD/BRL forward curve.

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4 August 2026
Credit Strategy

Supply for July (€bn)

	Corporates	Financials
July	17.0	13.9

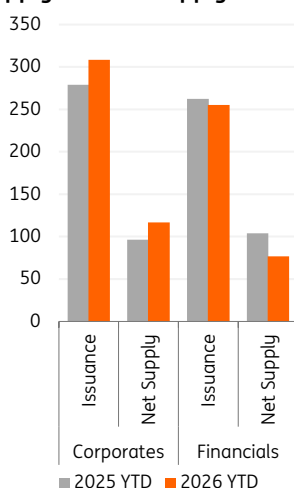
Source: ING, Dealogic

Supply FY and YTD (€bn)

Corporates	FY	YTD
2020	444	328
2021	336	211
2022	252	161
2023	304	197
2024	394	258
2025	455	279
2026	308	308
Financials	FY	YTD
2020	230	167
2021	258	156
2022	276	164
2023	308	215
2024	323	223
2025	414	263
2026	238	238

Source: ING, Dealogic

Supply and Net Supply YTD



Source: ING, Dealogic

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Euro Credit Supply

Summer lull shapes corporates and banks' July supply



Corporate Supply slows into the summer lull

- Corporate supply slowed to €17bn in July, from €52bn in June and €23bn in July 2025, reflecting the summer lull. Tight spreads and a 20-25bp rise in all-in yields supported demand overall within credit resulting in continued strong demand in primary. YTD issuance reached €308bn, 11% ahead of last year and second only to 2020. Redemptions of €17.7bn left July net supply at -€0.7bn and YTD net supply at €117bn.
- Utilities (€5.1bn) and TMT (€4.1bn) dominated July and account for 45% of YTD supply. They remain the main sector growth engines, up 45% and 31% YoY, supported by capex, particularly in TMT. Healthcare lags at -55%, while Autos and Oil & Gas saw no July issuance.
- Corporate hybrids paused in July but remain a key YTD driver at €36.1bn, almost double last year's €18.8bn and near the €37.5bn issued in full-year 2025. Refinancing, capex, tight hybrid spreads, M&A and rating defence should support further activity.
- The 3-6yr bucket dominated with €8.1bn, almost half of July supply, while €3.7bn was printed beyond 12 years. Reverse Yankees added €5.2bn, taking YTD supply to €74.1bn, and remain a major driver despite the EUR cost advantage becoming more issuer- and maturity-dependent as USD spreads tightened. ESG issuance added €6.7bn, lifting YTD supply to €71bn, 46% above last year.

The summer also impacts banks' activity on the primary market

- The bank bond supply dropped in all segments of the liability structure in July with a total of €11.6bn printed, down from over €52bn in June. The bulk of last month's supply stands in the senior non-preferred segment with €6.5bn printed while another €3.5bn was issued as senior preferred instruments.
- The most significant MoM issuance drop stems from the covered bond segment where we record only €1bn supplied by a German name. This is a decade low for covered bond issuances in July, even below July 2020, during the global pandemic. Despite the significant dip, covered bond supply remains well on track to reach our full year estimate of €170bn (of which €165bn in benchmark-size bonds), as it totals €126bn in 2026 YTD, up €17bn YoY.
- The senior unsecured bank bond supply is reaching €151bn, split with €52bn in senior preferred and €99bn in senior non-preferred issuances. This represents 65% and 79% of our full year estimates, respectively. The full year completion rate is similar in the bank capital segment with €21bn in Tier 2 instruments and €10bn in AT1 printed in 2026 YTD. That's 68% of the full year estimate for both segments, also still on track.

Fig 1 Euro corporate supply overview (€bn)

	2022	2023	2024	2025	2025 Jul	2026 Jun	2026 Jul	2025 YTD	2026 YTD	% diff
Auto	26	50	56	48	2	8	-	34	36	6%
Consumer	24	50	49	61	3	1	1	34	31	-10%
Healthcare	25	18	35	41	0	1	1	25	11	-55%
Industrial & Chemicals	43	54	71	63	2	7	3	40	37	-8%
Real Estate	24	7	24	38	1	5	3	19	22	14%
TMT	32	43	52	98	9	10	4	61	80	31%
Utility	58	55	69	64	4	11	5	41	59	45%
Oil & Gas	2	9	10	14	-	2	-	11	11	-7%
Others	16	16	26	28	2	6	1	13	22	65%
Corporate Hybrid	12	15	26	38	1	4	-	19	36	92%

Source: ING. Dealogic

Fig 2 Euro financial supply overview (€bn)

	2022	2023	2024	2025	2025 Jul	2026 Jun	2026 Jul	2025 YTD	2026 YTD	% diff
Bank Senior	196	226	198	233	11	24	10	152	151	-1%
of which NPS	73	112	118	149	8	13	7	94	99	5%
of which Pref	123	114	80	83	3	10	4	58	52	-11%
Bank Capital	27	29	56	60	1	5	1	40	31	-23%
Financial Services	37	40	50	95	7	12	3	57	43	-25%
Insurance	16	13	20	25	0	2	0	17	14	-18%
Covered	212	188	159	160	3	23	1	108	126	16%

Note: Dealogic sorts some Banks into the Financial Services sector

Source: ING. Dealogic

Fig 3 Euro corporate supply and net supply by month (€bn)

Issuance	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
2022	37.5	14.2	45.7	10.2	31.6	16.4	2.7	14.7	24.5	23.2	30.3	1.0	251.9
2023	40.2	27.6	25.3	18.0	48.0	26.0	12.1	22.3	32.5	7.8	39.6	4.3	303.5
2024	37.8	41.4	42.2	34.2	54.4	32.1	15.8	30.7	44.3	25.1	32.4	3.7	393.9
2025	36.0	42.8	28.0	31.1	69.1	49.3	22.8	17.4	52.6	27.8	70.1	8.3	455.2
2026	45.3	39.9	50.1	35.8	68.1	52.1	17.0						308.4
Net Supply	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
2022	15.6	-3.0	17.2	-7.7	13.0	-8.9	-11.8	7.8	-2.8	13.3	8.4	-11.6	29.2
2023	18.8	4.1	-5.2	-4.1	26.6	4.5	-3.4	15.1	-4.2	-10.6	18.0	-1.6	58.1
2024	8.8	24.4	18.9	9.7	26.4	12.8	-10.1	29.4	14.1	1.2	13.6	-12.6	136.4
2025	12.6	20.8	-9.9	-2.3	43.5	27.5	4.1	8.4	19.7	14.4	44.4	-5.7	177.5
Redemptions	21.9	18.3	33.4	27.4	38.8	34.1	17.7	12.4	33.8	26.1	28.8	11.7	304.3
2026	23.4	21.6	16.7	8.4	29.2	18.0	-0.7						116.8

Redemptions shown for 2026 only

Source: ING. Dealogic

Fig 4 Euro financial supply and net supply by month (€bn)

Issuance	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
2022	36.6	22.5	28.9	20.8	30.5	18.8	6.0	25.0	24.4	16.0	43.1	3.8	276.5
2023	68.1	25.6	16.2	25.2	36.6	31.3	8.9	17.2	36.6	14.5	26.6	2.5	309.1
2024	56.9	26.4	34.3	29.3	33.6	19.2	21.1	19.0	40.8	19.8	17.5	4.3	322.2
2025	57.4	42.1	34.0	22.9	50.6	33.6	21.5	29.8	34.8	27.0	49.5	10.5	413.6
2026	59.6	44.7	11.8	23.2	43.4	42.0	13.9						238.5
Net Supply	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
2022	2.2	1.8	6.0	2.7	16.7	4.2	-5.1	15.1	-0.1	-0.9	30.7	-8.1	65.1
2023	49.9	17.7	-10.9	11.7	18.2	11.8	-6.9	8.7	15.5	-2.9	13.9	-3.1	123.6
2024	39.9	12.2	21.2	10.1	6.1	-4.8	6.9	14.5	24.1	11.2	7.9	-2.9	146.4
2025	26.2	23.1	7.3	1.8	28.2	13.8	2.5	22.2	16.7	14.4	27.9	2.4	186.4
Redemptions	32.9	21.4	24.6	17.4	28.5	30.0	13.2	3.8	33.1	22.2	28.1	9.1	264.1
2026	26.8	23.3	-12.8	5.8	14.9	12.0	0.7						70.6

Covered Bonds excluded from aggregate throughout. Redemptions shown for 2026

Source: ING. Dealogic

Fig 5 Corporate supply and redemptions by month. 2026 (€bn)

Supply	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Autos	7.1	2.5	5.1	2.2	11.2	8.5	0.0						36.5
Consumer	4.7	5.9	8.7	4.2	6.2	0.9	0.5						31.1
Healthcare	0.0	0.0	0.5	5.9	3.3	0.7	1.0						11.4
Industrial	3.0	3.4	8.6	3.2	8.7	7.3	2.7						36.8
Real Estate	4.5	1.9	0.8	4.1	2.3	5.3	3.1						21.9
TMT	9.2	11.8	16.7	5.1	23.2	9.7	4.1						79.6
Utility	14.4	9.2	3.2	7.8	8.0	11.3	5.1						58.9
Oil & Gas	1.0	1.5	3.0	0.8	2.0	2.4	0.0						10.7
Others	1.6	3.9	3.7	2.7	3.3	6.1	0.5						21.6
Redemptions	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Autos	4.6	3.6	4.5	3.4	5.9	3.9	4.4	4.2	3.9	3.3	5.2	0.3	46.9
Consumer	2.4	3.1	6.0	3.4	6.4	4.0	0.6	2.1	3.3	2.2	2.2	0.2	35.8
Healthcare	2.5	0.8	3.6	0.0	4.1	3.6	0.6	1.0	5.5	2.6	2.8	1.1	28.1
Industrial	1.7	0.9	6.6	7.5	7.9	4.4	5.2	0.5	5.9	4.3	7.9	1.0	53.5
Real Estate	5.3	1.2	2.8	1.9	2.4	3.4	3.1	1.1	1.8	1.0	2.0	0.7	26.4
TMT	1.2	3.1	4.9	5.6	4.6	3.3	1.6	1.8	8.0	2.8	3.4	2.4	42.4
Utility	3.3	1.1	2.2	3.7	5.2	4.7	1.0	1.6	1.9	7.1	2.9	3.7	38.2
Oil & Gas	0.5	3.6	2.6	1.0	1.8	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.9	1.0	0.6	1.5	13.4
Others	0.7	1.2	0.3	1.0	0.7	6.8	1.4	0.1	2.8	2.0	1.8	0.8	19.5

Source: ING. Dealogic

Fig 6 Financial supply and redemptions by month. 2026 (€bn)

Supply	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Bank Senior	40.8	29.7	5.8	15.5	25.7	23.6	10.0						150.9
of which NPS	26.0	25.8	3.0	10.9	13.9	13.3	6.5						99.3
of which Pref	14.8	4.0	2.8	4.6	11.8	10.3	3.5						51.6
Bank Capital	8.8	4.3	0.0	3.2	9.0	5.1	0.5						30.8
Financial Services	6.2	8.5	5.4	2.8	5.1	11.0	3.4						42.4
Insurance	3.9	2.2	0.6	1.8	3.6	2.3	0.0						14.4
Covered	29.3	25.2	11.5	15.9	19.2	23.5	1.1						125.6
Redemptions	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Bank Senior	20.9	16.5	14.5	12.8	12.7	19.5	9.8	2.5	21.5	17.2	17.8	6.3	171.7
of which NPS	6.5	8.0	5.5	5.5	6.5	13.3	7.1	0.0	13.4	12.2	7.8	3.5	89.1
of which Pref	14.4	8.5	9.0	7.3	6.2	6.3	2.8	2.5	8.1	5.0	10.0	2.8	82.7
Bank Capital	4.1	1.3	6.3	1.6	9.4	5.2	0.2	0.0	3.8	1.1	3.3	1.3	37.3
Financial Services	7.1	3.3	3.8	2.3	2.6	5.3	1.9	1.3	6.0	2.9	6.3	1.6	44.5
Insurance	0.8	0.3	0.0	0.8	3.8	0.0	1.3	0.0	1.9	1.1	0.7	0.0	10.7
Covered	20.1	20.4	17.7	13.1	6.0	11.0	11.1	8.5	16.3	18.6	9.0	3.9	155.4

Source: ING. Dealogic

Fig 7 Euro supply, redemptions and net supply by year (€bn)

Corporates	YTD	FY	Reds	Net	Financials	YTD	FY	Reds	Net
2015	190	276	122	154	2015	177	258	321	-63
2016	191	306	144	162	2016	179	234	262	-28
2017	215	326	155	171	2017	148	224	269	-45
2018	176	282	157	125	2018	153	225	182	43
2019	223	392	170	222	2019	167	267	186	81
2020	328	444	201	242	2020	167	230	192	38
2021	211	336	213	123	2021	156	258	169	89
2022	161	252	223	29	2022	164	276	211	65
2023	197	304	245	58	2023	215	309	185	124
2024	258	394	258	136	2024	223	322	176	146
2025	279	455	278	177	2025	263	414	227	186
2026	308	308	304		2026	238	238	264	
2027			318		2027			263	
2028			307		2028			259	
2029			291		2029			242	

Source: ING. Dealogic

Fig 8 Subordinated supply. 2026 and 2025 (€bn)

2026	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
AT1	1.7	3.5	0.0	0.8	3.3	1.1	0.0						10.3
T2	7.1	0.8	0.0	2.4	5.8	4.0	0.5						20.5
Bank Capital	8.8	4.3	0.0	3.2	9.0	5.1	0.5						30.8
Corp Hybrids	7.6	9.5	4.9	9.6	0.9	3.7	0.0						36.2
2025	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
AT1	1.7	3.7	2.1	0.0	5.7	2.4	0.0	0.0	2.5	0.6	5.7	0.0	24.3
T2	6.6	6.0	2.5	0.7	3.5	3.8	1.4	5.0	0.5	0.8	4.8	0.0	35.4
Bank Capital	8.3	9.7	4.6	0.7	9.2	6.2	1.4	5.0	3.0	1.4	10.4	0.0	59.7
Corp Hybrids	4.8	0.0	1.7	0.9	5.9	4.6	1.0	0.5	6.1	4.2	7.4	0.6	37.5

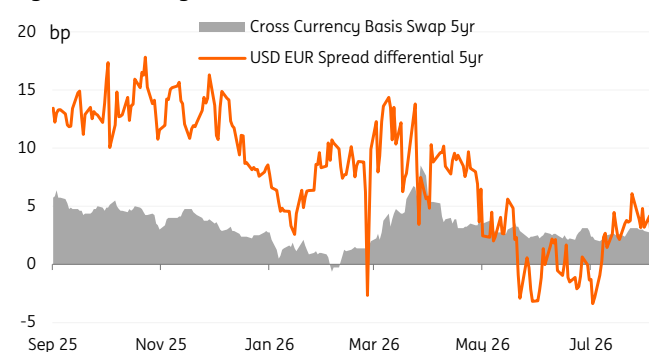
Source: ING. Dealogic

Fig 9 Reverse Yankee supply. 2026 and 2025 (€bn)

2026	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Corporate	4.2	12.1	24.2	5.3	18.5	4.7	5.2						74.1
Financial	5.1	11.6	0.3	1.4	1.8	2.9	5.0						28.0
Total	9.2	23.7	24.5	6.7	20.3	7.6	10.2						102.1
2025	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Corporate	2.5	16.2	3.4	10.2	11.2	6.7	5.4	0.6	7.5	1.4	25.6	1.8	62.1
Financial	8.6	1.4	5.1	10.7	2.9	3.6	4.8	1.5	1.8	6.1	13.0	2.8	154.3
Total	11.1	17.6	8.5	20.8	14.1	10.3	10.2	2.1	9.3	7.5	38.6	4.5	216.5

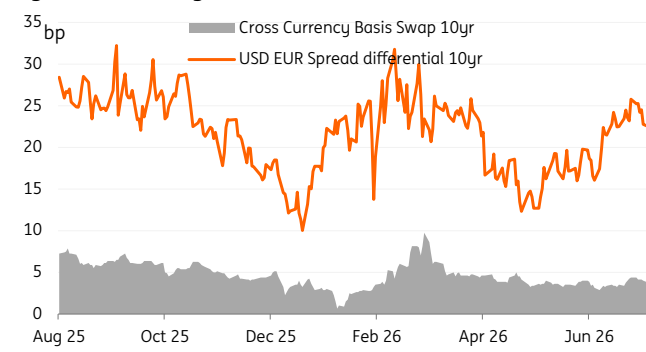
Source: ING. Dealogic

Fig 10 XCCY 5yr



Source: ING. IHS Markit, Refinitiv

Fig 11 XCCY 10yr



Source: ING. IHS Markit, Refinitiv

Fig 12 European. Yankee and Reverse Yankee supply (€bn)

Corporates	European	Yankee (US\$)	Rev Yankee	Financials	European	Yankee (US\$)	Rev Yankee
2015	145.6	108.5	62.7	2015	145.9	127.1	28.9
2016	173.7	113.9	65.8	2016	133.3	114	45.6
2017	192.2	103.2	65.7	2017	129.1	111.9	35.6
2018	181.1	131.2	32.0	2018	126.2	131.7	18.1
2019	231.1	96.6	98.3	2019	171.6	95.8	28.8
2020	283.1	152.3	68.9	2020	152.6	125.3	25.3
2021	182.2	108.4	64.5	2021	137.8	167	41.5
2022	161.0	90.6	34.0	2022	165.8	147.3	29.8
2023	190.1	106.1	44.0	2023	210.3	150.4	13.1
2024	233.0	144.2	65.3	2024	200.7	167.2	27.1
2025	259.3	145.8	92.2	2025	217.2	164.6	62.1
2026	169.2	106.6	74.1	2026	158.0	127.2	23.2

Source: ING

Fig 13 ESG supply per month 2026 (€bn)

Corporate	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Green	13.1	6.7	3.8	7.3	9.5	16.4	6.7						63.5
Social	1.8	0.0	0.0	1.0	0.0	0.9	0.0						3.7
Sustainable	0.9	0.5	0.1	0.0	1.4	1.0	0.0						3.8
ESG	15.7	7.2	3.9	8.3	10.9	18.3	6.7						71.0
Financial	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	June	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Green	6.4	9.3	2.5	5.9	11.8	10.6	0.5						46.9
Social	1.8	0.5	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.5						2.8
Sustainable	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.8	0.0	0.5						1.3
ESG	8.1	9.8	2.5	5.9	12.6	10.6	1.5						50.9
Covered	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	June	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Green	0.0	2.3	1.5	1.1	2.0	2.5	0.0						9.4
Social	0.0	1.0	0.0	0.0	0.6	0.0	0.0						1.6
Sustainable	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0						0.0
ESG	0.0	3.3	1.5	1.1	2.6	2.5	0.0						11.0

Source: ING. Dealogic – classified as ESG under Dealogic

Fig 14 ESG supply per year and YTD (€bn)

Corporate	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	2022 YTD	2023 YTD	2024 YTD	2025 YTD	2026 YTD
Green	61.7	64.1	87.6	78.0	63.5	38.5	38.8	57.1	42.2	63.5
Social	3.1	0.5	5.0	2.4	3.7	2.4	0.5	4.9	2.4	3.7
Sustainable	4.3	0.6	2.8	4.7	3.8	2.6	0.1	2.0	3.9	3.8
ESG	69.1	65.3	95.4	85.1	71.0	43.5	39.4	63.9	48.5	71.0
Financial	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	2022 YTD	2023 YTD	2024 YTD	2025 YTD	2026 YTD
Green	40.6	47.4	46.3	51.1	46.9	21.9	32.3	28.0	24.0	46.9
Social	5.3	7.8	6.8	9.0	2.8	2.0	4.5	3.1	5.8	2.8
Sustainable	0.8	3.1	1.7	2.3	1.3	0.3	1.3	1.0	1.3	1.3
ESG	46.7	58.2	54.8	62.4	50.9	24.2	38.0	32.1	31.0	50.9
Covered	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	2022 YTD	2023 YTD	2024 YTD	2025 YTD	2026 YTD
Green	16.8	47.1	11.3	12.5	9.4	9.5	47.1	9.5	9.3	9.4
Social	2.6	22.7	6.4	3.6	1.6	2.6	22.7	2.6	2.4	1.6
Sustainable	0.5	0.0	0.5	1.6	0.0	0.5	0.0	0.0	1.0	0.0
ESG	19.9	69.8	18.1	17.7	11.0	12.6	69.8	12.1	12.6	11.0

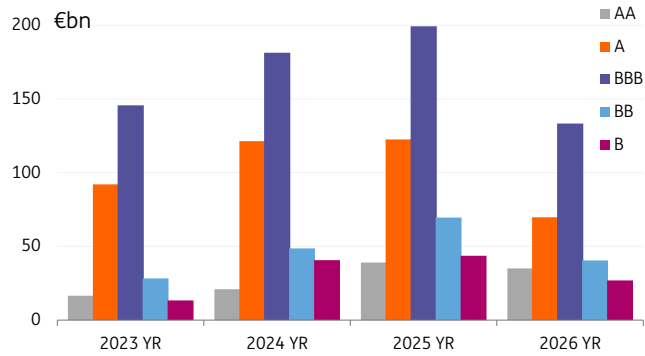
Source: ING. Dealogic – classified as ESG under Dealogic

Fig 15 Investment grade issuance by maturity, 2026 and 2025 (€bn)

2026	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	YTD
Corp 0-3yr	6.0	3.4	7.0	3.0	11.0	6.2	1.0						37.6
Corp 3-6yr	8.0	6.5	11.2	5.2	20.1	12.9	8.1						72.0
Corp 6-9yr	13.4	9.9	10.9	11.2	23.0	16.4	3.5						88.3
Corp 9-12yr	3.6	5.4	8.1	3.6	5.5	8.1	0.7						34.9
Corp 12yrs+	14.5	14.7	12.9	12.7	8.5	8.6	3.7						75.6
Bank 0-3yr	3.5	6.3	1.3	0.0	2.0	6.6	1.8						21.4
Bank 3-6yr	21.2	11.7	2.8	12.2	15.3	10.2	6.5						79.7
Bank 6-9yr	6.5	6.3	1.8	3.3	7.9	7.0	1.8						34.4
Bank 9-12yr	17.4	6.5	0.0	3.2	9.5	5.0	0.5						42.0
Bank 12yrs+	1.0	3.3	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0						4.3
2025	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	YTD
Corp 0-3yr	4.1	3.5	2.1	1.9	9.6	5.3	2.4	3.6	10.2	1.2	7.9	2.2	53.8
Corp 3-6yr	7.4	7.3	7.4	4.5	15.8	10.5	5.3	1.9	10.7	4.9	11.5	3.2	90.3
Corp 6-9yr	10.3	16.1	9.8	12.1	17.3	19.8	5.6	6.0	16.0	12.4	17.4	2.3	144.9
Corp 9-12yr	4.9	5.4	5.5	4.7	12.2	5.2	2.4	2.4	4.9	1.7	9.2	0.0	58.4
Corp 12yrs+	9.3	10.5	3.2	8.1	14.2	8.6	7.3	3.5	10.7	7.7	24.1	0.6	107.8
Bank 0-3yr	10.6	3.5	4.5	2.5	0.3	2.9	1.3	2.0	1.3	1.0	2.0	3.3	35.1
Bank 3-6yr	18.8	9.3	9.6	7.9	17.2	13.0	6.7	4.8	7.8	8.2	14.8	2.4	120.4
Bank 6-9yr	13.0	9.4	3.6	0.5	7.8	0.8	1.0	5.8	9.3	5.4	7.9	0.0	64.3
Bank 9-12yr	10.3	13.8	3.5	5.9	7.0	7.8	3.2	9.3	4.8	3.3	7.5	0.0	76.2
Bank 12yrs+	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	1.0	0.0	1.0

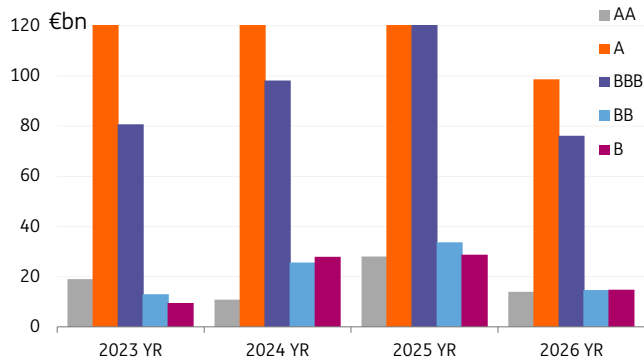
Source: ING. Dealogic

Fig 16 Corporate supply per S&P rating (€bn)



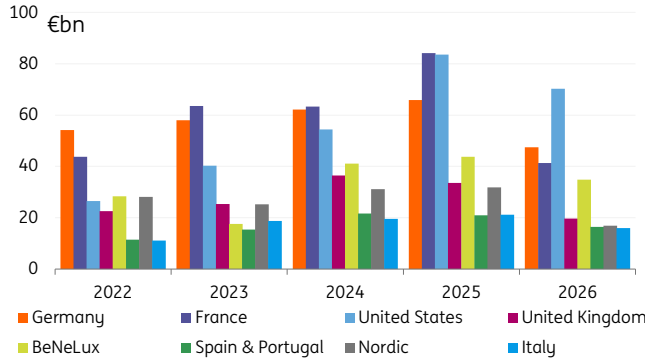
Source: ING. Dealogic

Fig 17 Financial supply per S&P rating (€bn)



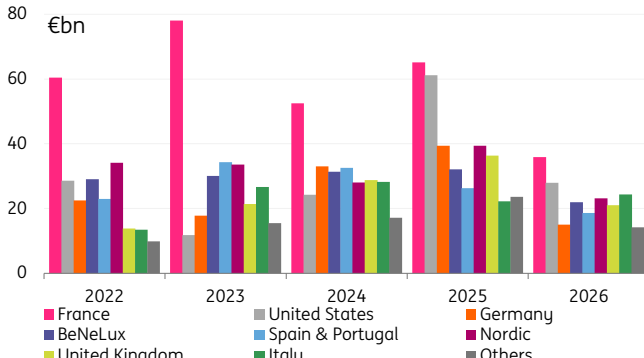
Source: ING. Dealogic

Fig 18 Corporate supply per country (€bn)



Source: ING. Dealogic

Fig 19 Financial supply per country (€bn)



Source: ING. Dealogic

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